

A SUMMER INTERNSHIP PROJECT REPORT

**“A study on the competitors of "pens and premium portfolio" of
ITC ESPB division in Siliguri with special reference to the
"PAPERKRAFT" pens.”**



SUBMITTED TO IAEER'S PUNE INSTITUTE OF BUSINESS MANAGEMENT FOR
PGDM

BY

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PGDM Batch 2023-2025

PRN: DM23D50 / Roll No.: MO120

UNDER THE GUIDANCE OF

Dr. POORNA CHANDRA/ Prof. SUSHANT KAPOOR

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PIRANGUT, PUNE- 412115





Pune Institute of Business Management

Post Graduate Diploma in Management (PGDM) | Approved by AICTE & NSDC

To whom so ever it may concern

This is to certify that the Project Report titled **“A study on the competitors of "pens and premium portfolio" of ITC ESPB division in Siliguri with special reference to the "PAPERKRAFT" pens**, is an authentic work carried out by Mr. Supradip Das from **PGDM** of IAEER's Pune Institute of Business Management for PGDM, Pune - 412115 as a fulfilment of PGDM Course. He/ She has worked under our guidance and satisfactorily completed his/ her project work.

Place: Pune

Date:

Signature of Internal Guide

Signature of HOD

Signature of Director
Examinations

Signature of Controller of



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Post Graduate Diploma in Management (PGDM) | Approved by AICTE

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DECLARATION BY THE STUDENT

I hereby certify that the work which is being presented in the present winter Internship Report entitled “**A study on the competitors of "pens and premium portfolio" of ITC ESPB division in Siliguri with special reference to the "PAPERKRAFT" pens**”, is for fulfilment of the requirement for the award of Degree of **Post Graduate Diploma in Management, Pune Institute of Business Management, Pune, India** is an authentic record of my own work carried out under the supervision and guidance of **Dr. Poorna Chandra and Prof. Sushant Kapoor of Department of Marketing**.

In keeping with the ethical practice in reporting scientific information, due acknowledgements have been made wherever the findings of others have been cited.

SUPRADIP DAS

(Student Name and sign)

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

The internship opportunity with ITC Ltd., provided me a platform to work with highly qualified and experienced individuals who opened up new avenues of learning and professional development for me. Therefore, I consider myself as a very lucky individual as I was provided with an opportunity to be a part of it.

This internship would not have been the same without the enthusiasm and vigor provided by Mr. Ranjeet Singh, Area Sales Executive whose behavior was outstanding. Hence, I would like to express my deepest gratitude to him who heartily welcomed me for the internship and whose guidance and dedication encouraged me throughout the winter internship program.

I express my deepest thanks to Dr. Poorna Chandra sir and Mr. Sushant Kapoor sir, PIBM for taking part in useful decision & giving necessary advices and guidance and arranged all facilities to make life easier all throughout the internship program. Their valuable knowledge helped me gain a better grasp on Marketing which has helped me understand Marketing & Operations Department in a better way.

It is my radiant sentiment to place on record my best regard, deepest sense of gratitude to, for their careful and precious guidance which were extremely valuable for my study both theoretically and practically.

Sincerely,

Students Name: SUPRADIP DAS

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TO WHOMSOEVER IT MAY CONCERN

Date-12th August, 2024

This is to certify that Supradip Das from PIBM, has completed his Internship at ITC Limited, Kolkata Marketing Branch. He has worked on the Sales and Marketing Project from 10/06/2024 to 10/08/2024. His project title was **"A Study on the Competitors of Pens and Premium Portfolio"**.

On behalf of ITC Limited, we wish him good luck and a great future ahead.

While on this, we would also like to state that all information and data acquired in the process is confidential in nature and the sole property of ITC Limited., and should not be shared/published/circulated without our written permission and is only meant for his academic purpose.

Thanking You,

For ITC Limited, Kolkata

1. Project Synopsis

Project Title:	A study on the competitors of "pens and premium portfolio" of ITC ESPB division in Siliguri with special reference to the "PAPERKRAFT" pens.
Company Name:	ITC Ltd.
Student Name:	Supradip Das
Student Roll No:	MO120
Project Guide Name:	Mr. Ranjeet Singh
Project Guide Designation:	Area Sales Executive
Project Guide Name:	Dr. Poorna Chandra Mr. Sushant Kapoor
Project Guide Designation:	Professor, Marketing department, PIBM
Confidential Report (Yes/No)	Yes
Duration of project:	60 Days

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1. Executive Summary

This report presents a comprehensive analysis of the Siliguri market for PAPERKRAFT pens, conducted during a two-month internship at ITC's ESPB division. The research encompassed a multifaceted approach, including an in-depth examination of sales and distribution operations, coupled with a rigorous market research study. Key accomplishments during the internship period involved expanding the distributor network, significantly increasing the penetration of PAPERKRAFT pens within the target market, and identifying critical market dynamics that influence product performance.

A robust research methodology was employed, incorporating both quantitative and qualitative research techniques. This methodology enabled a deep understanding of consumer preferences, retailer behaviors, and the competitive landscape. The findings of this research offer invaluable insights for developing and implementing effective marketing and sales strategies to enhance PAPERKRAFT's market position within the highly competitive Siliguri market.

By meticulously examining consumer attitudes, retailer perceptions, and market trends, this report provides actionable recommendations to optimize PAPERKRAFT's product positioning, distribution channels, and promotional activities. Ultimately, the goal of this research is to contribute to the growth and success of the PAPERKRAFT brand in the Siliguri region.

Chapter 1: Introduction

2. Introduction to opportunity/ challenges

The Indian premium pen market presents a significant opportunity for ITC's PAPERKRAFT brand. However, current market demand in Siliguri appears low. Siliguri, a vibrant commercial hub in West Bengal, India, presents a significant opportunity for ITC's PAPERKRAFT brand in the premium pen market. However, observations within the ESPB division suggest a concerning reality: low demand for PAPERKRAFT pens compared to established competitors like Parker and Pierre Cardin. This discrepancy between national potential and local performance necessitates a closer look. This research project aims to bridge this gap by utilizing business analytics to understand the underlying reasons for this disparity and develop a data-driven approach to elevate PAPERKRAFT's brand awareness, sales, and market share in Siliguri.

Challenges and the Path Forward:

- **Limited Brand Awareness:** Consumers in Siliguri might not be familiar with PAPERKRAFT, placing the brand at a disadvantage compared to well-known competitors. This lack of recognition hinders purchase consideration. To address this, the research will delve into consumer awareness levels and brand perception of PAPERKRAFT compared to competitors.
- **Marketing Strategy Gaps:** Existing marketing efforts could be missing the mark, failing to reach the target audience in Siliguri through the right channels and with the most compelling messaging. The research will analyse current marketing strategies and identify any gaps in reaching or resonating with the target demographic.
- **Retailer Purchase Behaviour:** Understanding the factors influencing local retailers' decisions to stock PAPERKRAFT pens is crucial. Are profit margins, brand reputation, or promotional support the key drivers? By identifying these factors, the research can help develop strategies to incentivize retailers to stock PAPERKRAFT pens.
- **Regional Market Dynamics:** Siliguri's location as a trade hub exposes it to competition from neighbouring countries and states. Understanding these competitors' pricing, brand presence, and product offerings is essential to develop a competitive

edge. The research will analyse the competitive landscape and identify potential threats and opportunities.

3. Background of the study

This research project is driven by the observation of low PAPERKRAFT pen demand in Siliguri by an ITC ESPB division employee. This discrepancy between the brand's national potential and its local performance necessitates a deeper investigation. The project aims to provide actionable insights to enhance PAPERKRAFT's brand positioning and sales performance in the Siliguri market.

4. Sector, company, product, service analysis

Sector: Premium Writing Instruments

Company: ITC Limited (PAPERKRAFT Brand)

Product: PAPERKRAFT offers a range of premium pens (gel, rollerball, fountain) targeting professionals and students seeking superior writing experience, design aesthetics, and potentially innovative features like refillable cartridges.

Services: While the core product is the pen itself, after-sales service or warranty programs could be additional service offerings to consider. Investigating if such services are currently offered and their potential impact on purchase decisions would be valuable.

5. Statement of Problem

PAPERKRAFT pens face a critical challenge in Siliguri: low market demand. This could be attributed to several factors:

- **Limited Brand Awareness:** Consumers might be unaware of PAPERKRAFT's existence or its value proposition compared to established competitors.
- **Ineffective Marketing Strategies:** Current marketing efforts might not be reaching the target audience in Siliguri or failing to resonate with their needs and preferences.
- **Unidentified Factors Influencing Retailer Purchase Decisions:** Understanding the factors that motivate retailers to stock PAPERKRAFT pens is crucial to improve product availability and sales.

- **Regional Competition Impacting Sales Potential:** Location as a hub spot exposes it to competition from neighbouring countries and states. Understanding these competitors' strategies is essential to develop a competitive edge.
- **Price Sensitivity:** Is price a major factor influencing purchase decisions in Siliguri compared to other parts of India?
- **Product Features:** How do PAPERKRAFT pens compare to competitors in terms of ink quality, writing smoothness,

6. Motivation for solving problem

Addressing the low demand for PAPERKRAFT pens in Siliguri through a data-driven approach can significantly benefit ITC in several ways:

- **Increased Sales:** By understanding consumer and retailer preferences, PAPERKRAFT can develop targeted marketing campaigns and sales incentives, leading to a rise in sales and market share in Siliguri.
- **Enhanced Brand Image:** A successful research-backed campaign can elevate PAPERKRAFT's brand perception in Siliguri, establishing it as a premium and trustworthy choice for writing instruments. This can have a positive halo effect on the brand image nationally.
- **Gaining Market Insights:** The data collected from this research will provide valuable insights into consumer behaviour and retailer preferences specific to the Siliguri market. This knowledge can be used to inform future product development and marketing strategies, ensuring PAPERKRAFT remains relevant and competitive in the ever-evolving market.
- **Cost Savings:** Optimizing marketing efforts based on research findings can lead to cost savings by eliminating ineffective campaigns and focusing resources on channels with higher return on investment.
- **Improved Decision Making:** Data-driven insights can empower ITC to make informed decisions about product pricing, distribution strategies, and promotional activities in Siliguri.

7. Purpose of the project

This project aims to leverage business analytics to achieve the following objectives:

Understanding Consumer Preferences:

- Conduct surveys and focus groups with students and professionals in Siliguri to identify the features, price points, and brand perceptions that influence their pen purchasing decisions.
- Analyse the data to understand what aspects of a pen are most valued by the target audience (e.g., smooth writing experience, ink quality, design aesthetics, brand reputation).

Understanding Retailer Purchase Behaviour:

- Conduct interviews with retailers in Siliguri to understand the factors influencing their decisions to stock PAPERKRAFT pens. This could include profit margins, brand reputation, promotional support, minimum order quantities, and return policies.
- Analyze the data to identify key drivers influencing retailer stocking decisions and develop strategies to address them.

Competitive Landscape Analysis:

- Identify and research major competitors in the premium pen segment in Siliguri, including brands from neighbouring countries and states.
- Analyze competitor pricing, product offerings, brand positioning, and marketing strategies in the Siliguri market.
- Identify potential opportunities and threats based on the competitive landscape.

Developing a Go-to-Market Strategy:

- Based on the research findings on consumer preferences, retailer buying behavior, and the competitive landscape, develops a data-driven go-to-market strategy for PAPERKRAFT pens in Siliguri.
- This strategy will include recommendations for:
 - **Marketing Campaigns:** Tailored marketing campaigns to reach the target audience in Siliguri through the most effective channels (e.g., digital marketing,

in-store promotions, influencer marketing) with compelling messaging that resonates with their needs and preferences.

- **Retailer Incentives:** Developing targeted incentives for retailers to encourage them to stock PAPERKRAFT pens, such as improved margins, promotional support, or co-operative advertising programs.
- **Product Assortment Optimization:** Analyzing if there's a need to adjust PAPERKRAFT's product offerings in Siliguri to better cater to local preferences (e.g., introducing new price points, design variations, or features).

8. Limitations of the project

- **Time Constraints:** This research project will likely face time limitations. It is important to define a realistic timeframe for data collection, analysis, and report writing. Considering these constraints, the research design might need to be adjusted (e.g., sample size for surveys or focus groups).
- **Budget Constraints:** Budget limitations could restrict the scope of data collection methods. Exploring cost-effective options like online surveys and utilizing publicly available data can be beneficial. Partnering with relevant departments within ITC could potentially provide access to additional resources.
- **Limited Sample Size:** The sample size for surveys and focus groups might be limited due to time and budget constraints. However, statistically valid sampling techniques can be used to ensure the findings are representative of the target audience.
- **External Factors:** External factors like economic conditions or sudden changes in consumer preferences could influence the research findings. Regular monitoring of market trends might be necessary to account for such possibilities.
- **Data Availability:** Access to relevant data might be limited. Collaboration with marketing and sales teams within ITC could provide access to existing customer data on the Siliguri market.
- **Regional Specificity:** The findings of this research project might be specific to the Siliguri market and may not be directly generalizable to other regions in India. However, the learning can provide valuable insights for developing future research projects in other markets.

9. Business Objectives of the project

This business analytics project has two main objectives, a primary objective and a secondary objective, to address the challenges faced by PAPERKRAFT pens in Siliguri.

Primary Objectives

To develop a data-driven go-to-market strategy for PAPERKRAFT pens in Siliguri that will increase brand awareness, improve sales performance, and gain market share in the premium pen segment.

This primary objective focuses on achieving tangible results for PAPERKRAFT in the Siliguri market. It encompasses all the research activities aimed at understanding consumer preferences, retailer buying behaviour, and the competitive landscape. Based on the insights gathered, the project will create a strategic roadmap for marketing and sales efforts to achieve the desired outcomes.

Secondary Objective

To gain valuable market insights specific to the Siliguri market that can inform future product development and marketing strategies for PAPERKRAFT on a broader scale.

This secondary objective serves a long-term purpose. The research conducted in Siliguri can provide valuable learning about consumer preferences and market dynamics in a specific regional context. These insights can be used to refine PAPERKRAFT's national marketing strategies and potentially inform future product development decisions to cater to a wider audience.

Chapter 2: Review of Literature

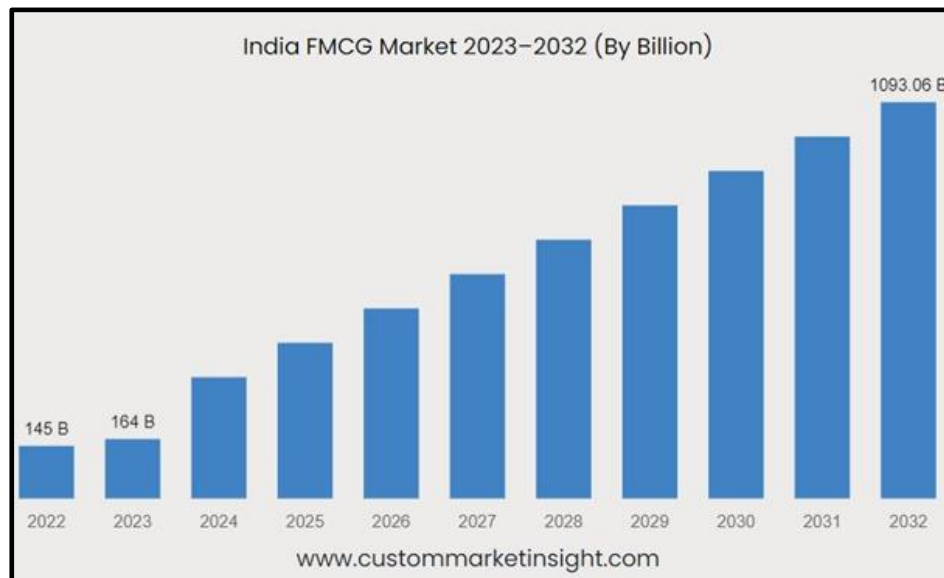
1. About the sector

ITC Limited is a company that makes and sells products that people use quickly and often, like food and drinks. These kinds of products are called fast-moving consumer goods (FMCG). In

India, the FMCG industry is the fourth biggest business sector and provides jobs to about 3 million people.

2. Market Size

According to Customer Market Insight (CMI)., the Indian FMCG market is booming, with a value of \$164 billion in 2023 and expected to grow to \$1093 billion by 2032. This represents a significant increase of 21.61% per year.

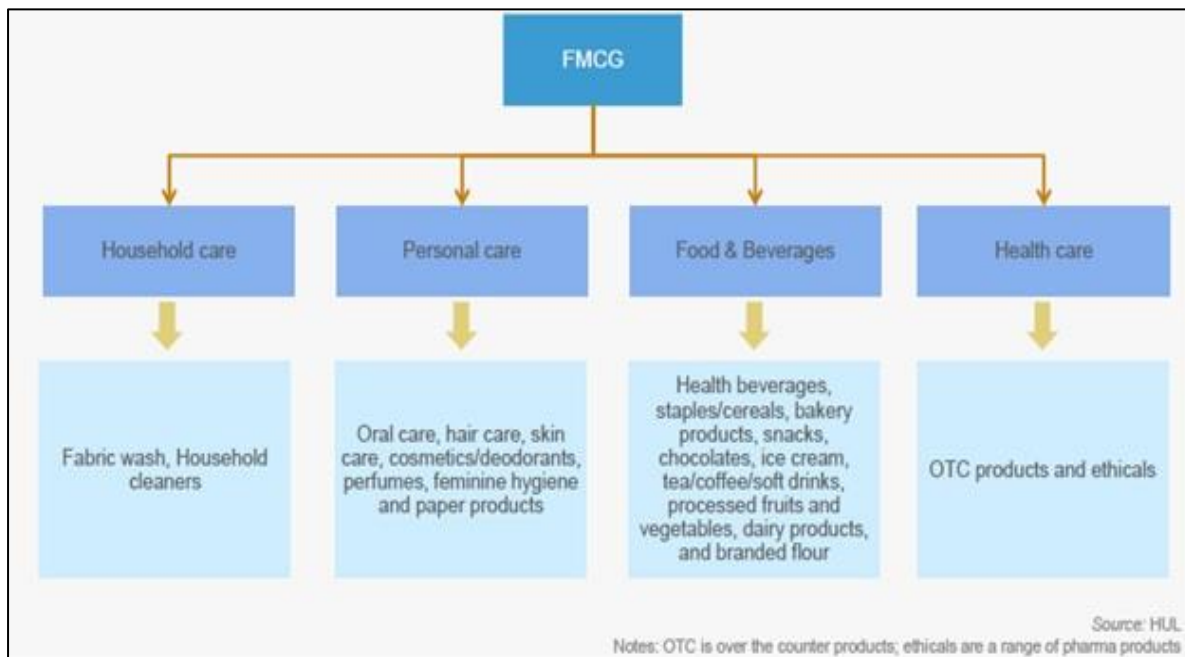
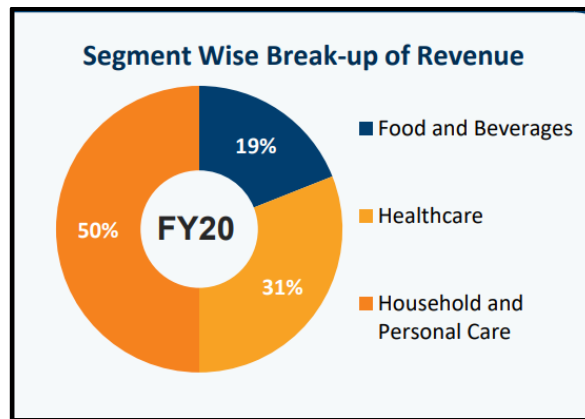


3. Sector Contribution to GDP

According to the report by OMNIFIN publication, the FMCG industry in India is very important. It employs more than 10 million people and contributes about 10% to the country's economy. Food, drinks, household items, and personal care products make up 80% of the sales in this industry.

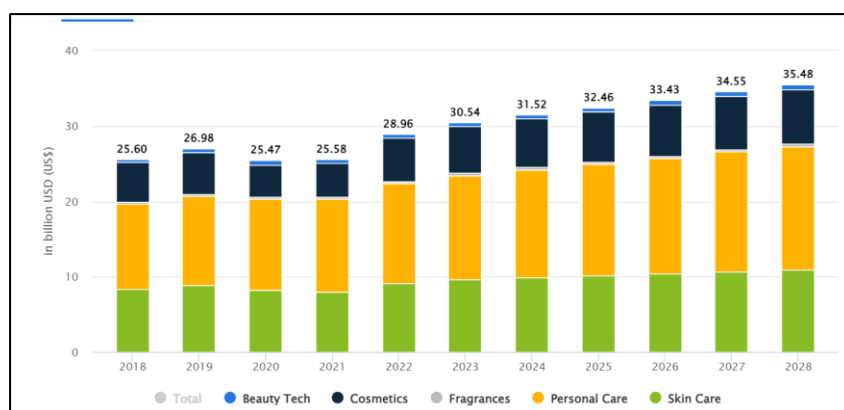
4. Sector Composition

- HOUEHOLD
- FOOD AND BEVERAGES
- PERSONAL CARE
- HEALTHCARE

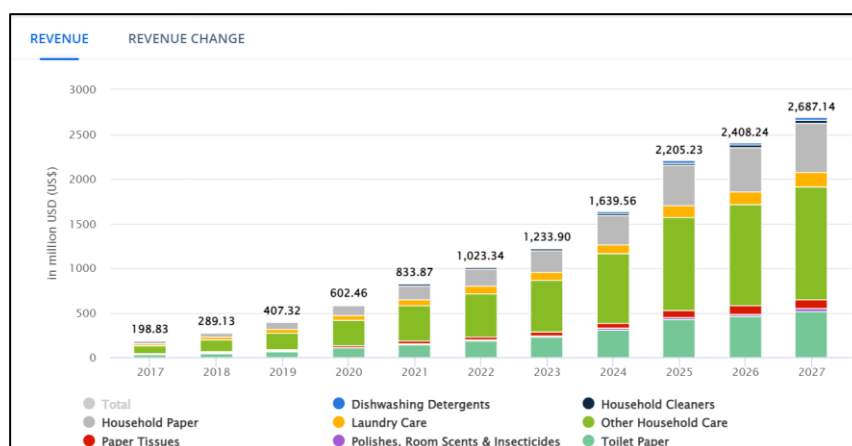


5. Sector & Sector Composition CAGR

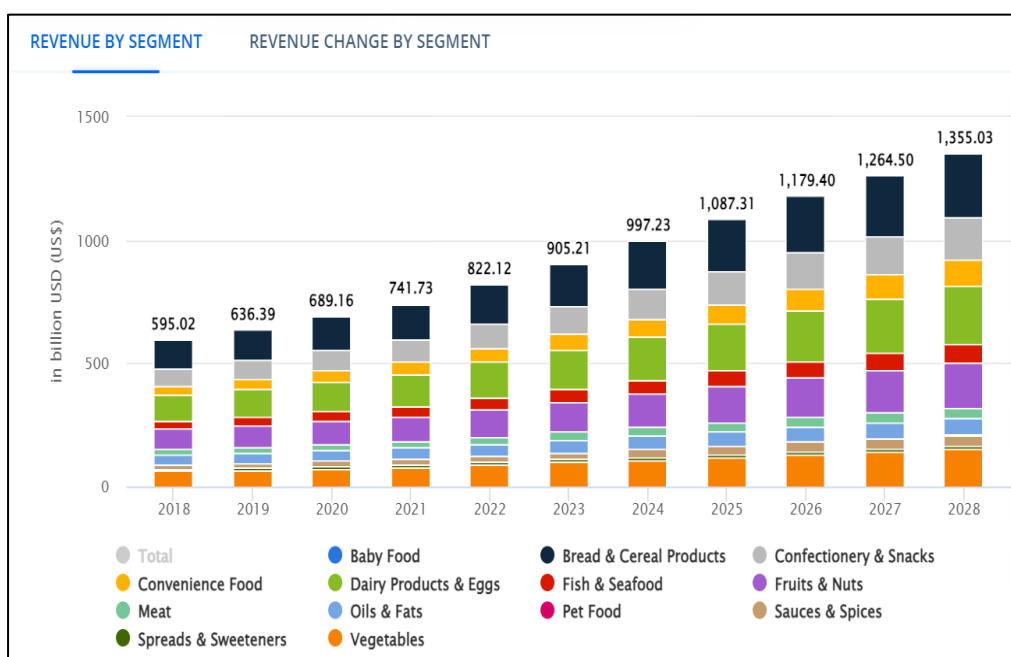
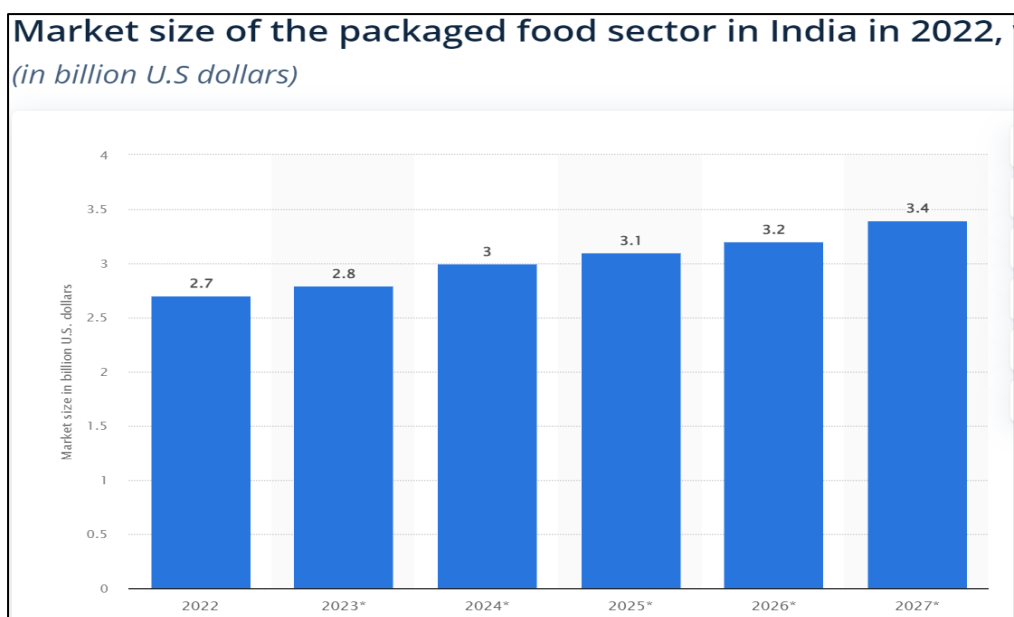
- **India's beauty and personal care market**, presently valued at \$16.8 billion, is going to grow at a compound annual rate of 11%, with cosmetics and perfumes categories growing at a faster pace.



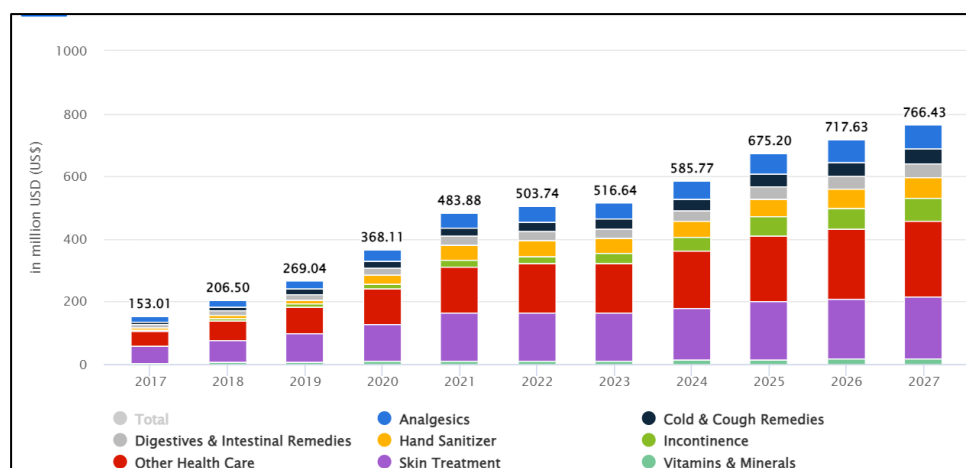
According to a report, the market for household cleaning products in India was worth \$7.5 billion in 2022. It is expected to grow to \$21.9 billion by 2028, with an average growth rate of 18.9% during this period. The main factors driving this growth are people becoming more aware of the importance of keeping their homes clean, the impact of COVID-19, and the availability of new and innovative cleaning products. Fabric care products make up 68% of the household care market.



According to a report, the food and beverages sector in India accounts for 3% of the country's GDP and about two-thirds of the total retail market. The market size for food and beverages in India is expected to reach \$504.92 billion by 2027, with a growth rate of 11.05%. The packaged food sector alone is estimated to grow from \$2.7 billion to \$3.4 billion by 2027.



The healthcare sector in India is one of the biggest sectors in terms of money and jobs. It has been growing quickly, with a 22% increase each year since 2016. This sector already employs 4.7 million people directly. In the future, it has the potential to create another 2.7 million jobs between 2017 and 2022, which is more than 500,000 new jobs per year.



6. Sector & Sector Composition growth/de-growth catalyst

Growth Catalysts

1. **Rising Disposable Income:** According to a report by McKinsey Global Institute, the Indian middle class is expected to grow significantly in the coming years, boosting demand for FMCG products.
2. **Urbanization:** India's urbanization rate has been steadily increasing, reaching 34.8% in 2021. This shift towards urban lifestyles drives demand for FMCG products.
3. **Changing Consumer Preferences:** Consumers are becoming more health-conscious, seeking convenient products, and willing to pay a premium for quality. For example, the market for organic and natural products has seen substantial growth.
4. **Rural Market Growth:** The rural FMCG market is expanding rapidly due to increased incomes and improved distribution networks. According to a report by KPMG, the rural FMCG market is expected to grow at a faster rate than the urban market in the coming years.
5. **E-commerce:** The rise of e-commerce platforms has provided new channels for FMCG companies to reach consumers. According to a report by RedSeer Consulting, the Indian e-commerce market is expected to grow at a CAGR of 25% from 2021 to 2025.
6. **Government Initiatives:** Government policies such as subsidies, tax incentives, and infrastructure development have supported the growth of the FMCG sector.

De-Growth Catalysts

1. **Economic Slowdowns:** During periods of economic slowdown or recession, consumer spending on non-essential goods like FMCG products may decline. For example, the COVID-19 pandemic led to a temporary slowdown in the FMCG sector.
2. **Inflation:** Rising inflation can erode consumer purchasing power, leading to reduced demand for FMCG products. However, India's inflation rate has been relatively stable in recent years.
3. **Competition:** Intense competition from both domestic and international players can put pressure on FMCG companies to lower prices or innovate to maintain market share.
4. **Regulatory Challenges:** Changes in government regulations, such as those related to taxation, labelling, or packaging, can impact the FMCG sector. However, India's government has generally been supportive of the FMCG industry.
5. **Supply Chain Disruptions:** Global events like pandemics or geopolitical tensions can disrupt supply chains, leading to shortages and price increases. The COVID-19 pandemic highlighted the vulnerability of global supply chains.

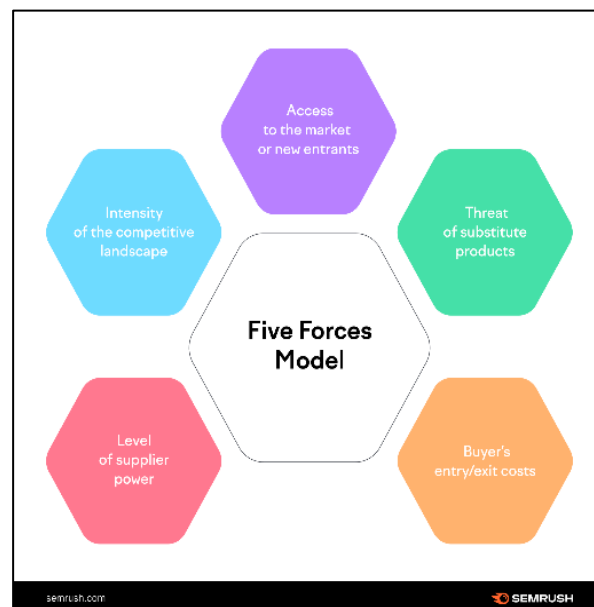
7. Government Initiatives & FDI

The Indian FMCG sector has witnessed substantial growth, propelled by a combination of government initiatives and foreign direct investment (FDI).

- i. **100% FDI allowed:** The government has permitted 100% FDI in food processing and single-brand retail, and 51% FDI in multi-brand retail. This has attracted significant foreign investment, leading to increased competition, technology transfer, and job creation.
- ii. **Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme:** The PLI scheme for the food processing industry, with an outlay of US\$ 1.4 billion, aims to boost domestic manufacturing, exports, and job creation.
- iii. **Focus on Rural Markets:** Government initiatives like the National Rural Livelihoods Mission (NRLM) and Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY) have improved rural infrastructure and purchasing power, expanding the FMCG market.
- iv. **GST Implementation:** The introduction of the Goods and Services Tax (GST) has led

- v. to a simplified tax structure, reducing logistics costs and improving supply chain efficiency for FMCG companies.
- vi. FDI in the FMCG Sector
- vii. India has been a lucrative destination for foreign investors in the FMCG sector. The industry has attracted substantial FDI, contributing to its growth and development.
- viii. FDI inflows: Between April 2000 and December 2023, the food processing industry received US\$ 12,466 million in FDI.
- ix. Sectoral impact: FDI has led to increased competition, technology transfer, and job creation in the FMCG sector. It has also helped in modernizing supply chains and improving product quality.
- x. Major investors: Companies from countries like the US, the UK, and Singapore have been significant investors in the Indian FMCG sector.

8. Porter 5 Force Model Analysis



The Indian FMCG sector is a highly competitive landscape characterized by intense rivalry and significant barriers to entry.

Threat of New Entrants: High

Established FMCG giants, such as Hindustan Unilever, with a market capitalization of INR 6.2 lakh crore as of April 2023, benefit from strong brand loyalty, extensive distribution networks, and economies of scale. This creates a significant barrier for new entrants. For instance, the average cost of launching a new FMCG product in India is estimated to be around INR 10-15 crores, deterring many potential competitors.

Bargaining Power of Suppliers: Moderate

While India boasts a diverse supplier base for the FMCG industry, the bargaining power of individual suppliers is generally low. However, in specific segments like packaging materials or key raw materials, suppliers might exert some influence, especially during periods of shortage or price fluctuations.

Bargaining Power of Buyers: High

The Indian FMCG market is characterized by a large and diverse consumer base with a wide range of choices. Modern trade channels, such as organized retail, have gained significant power in recent years, enabling them to negotiate favourable terms with FMCG companies. Moreover, the growing popularity of private labels offers consumers additional alternatives, intensifying competition.

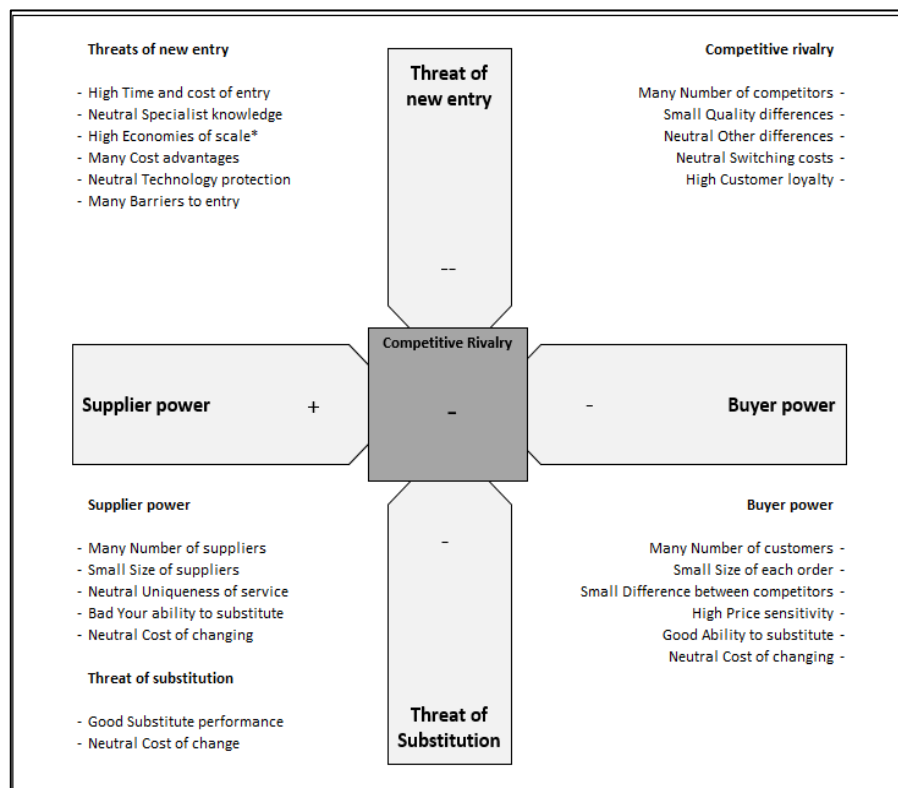
Threat of Substitutes: High

The FMCG sector faces constant pressure from substitute products. The increasing health consciousness among consumers has led to a surge in demand for substitutes like organic and natural products. Additionally, the growing popularity of e-commerce platforms has expanded consumer choices, making it essential for FMCG companies to innovate and adapt to changing preferences.

Rivalry Among Existing Competitors: Intense

The Indian FMCG market is highly fragmented with numerous players, including multinational giants and strong domestic brands. Intense competition has led to price wars, heavy advertising spends, and a relentless focus on product innovation. For instance, the market for hair care

products is dominated by players like Hindustan Unilever, Procter & Gamble, and L'Oreal, resulting in fierce competition for market share.

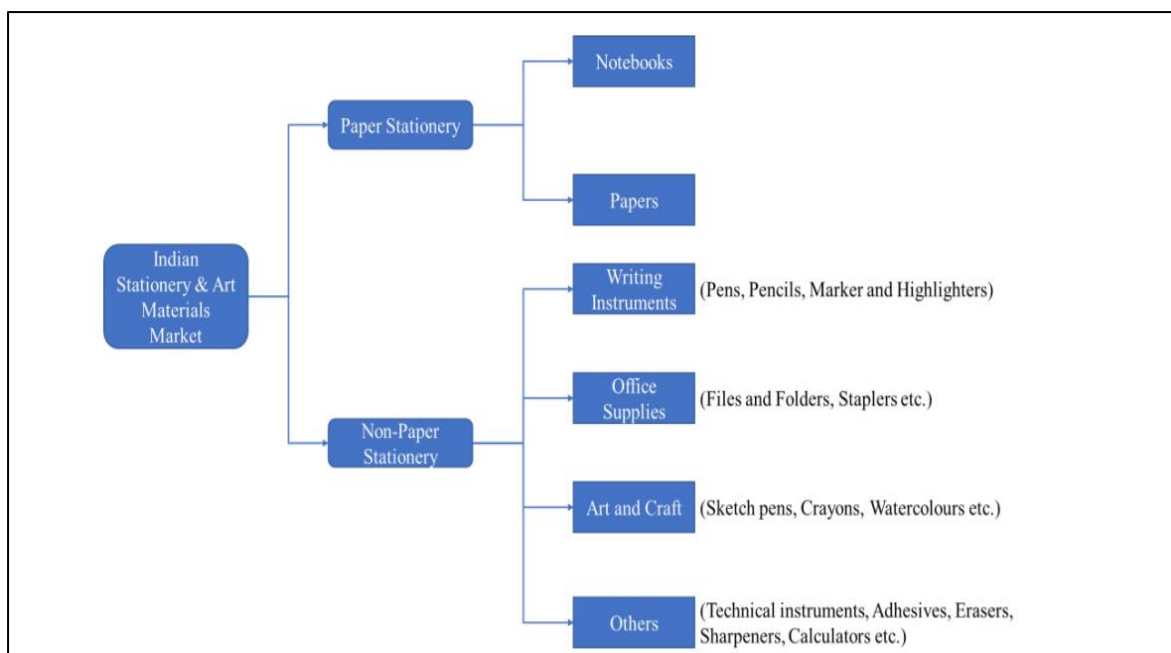


1. Education and stationary product market:

The Indian stationery and art materials market can be broadly categorized into two primary segments: paper stationery and non-paper stationery. While both segments contribute significantly to the overall market, non-paper stationery products generally command a larger market share in terms of value.

Paper stationery primarily encompasses notebooks and paper. Within this segment, notebooks constitute the more substantial revenue generator.

Conversely, non-paper stationery is a more diverse category, encompassing writing instruments, office supplies, art and craft materials, and other miscellaneous items. Among these, writing instruments typically hold the largest market share in terms of value.

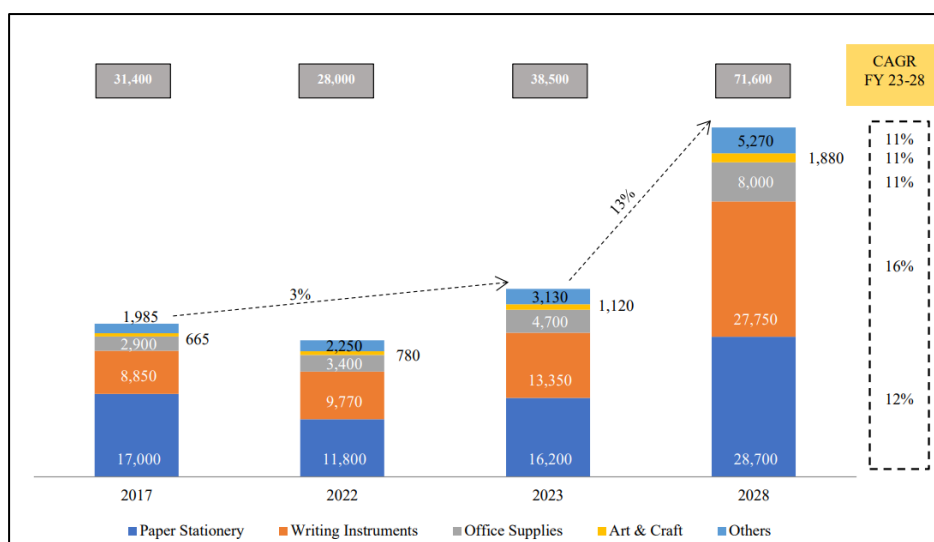


(Industry report, DOMS, 2023)

The Indian stationery and art materials market has seen steady growth, reaching an estimated value of INR 38,500 crore in FY 23. However, the COVID-19 pandemic caused a significant decline in sales due to school and office closures. The market rebounded strongly in FY 22 with a 35% growth rate as restrictions eased. Looking ahead, the market is projected to maintain a robust growth trajectory, expanding at a CAGR of approximately 13% from FY 23 to FY 28, reaching INR 71,600 crore by FY 28.

Non-paper stationery products dominate the market, accounting for about 58% of the total value in FY 23, primarily driven by writing instruments (60%), followed by office supplies (21%) and art and craft materials (5%). On the other hand, paper stationery, mainly comprising notebooks (65%) and paper (35%), contributes to the remaining 42% of the market.

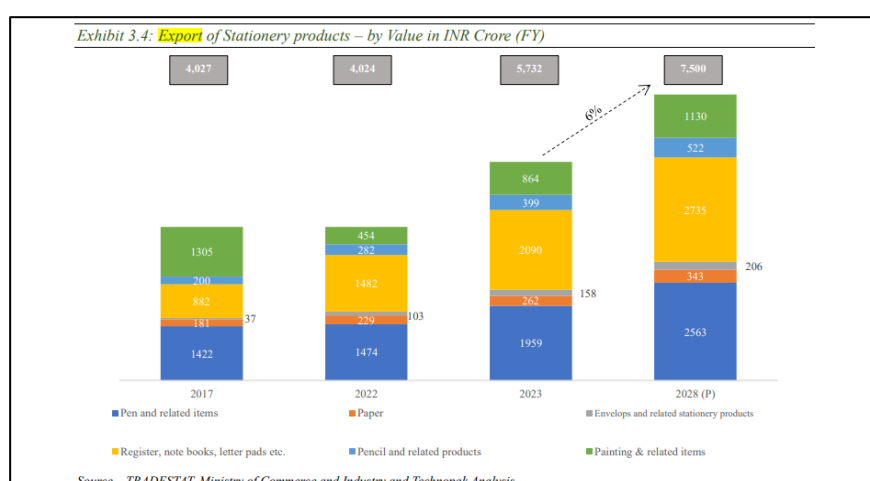
Market projections indicate a faster growth rate for non-paper stationery at a CAGR of 14% during FY 23-28, reaching INR 42,900 crore by FY 28. Paper stationery is expected to grow at a slightly slower pace of 12% CAGR, reaching INR 28,700 crore by FY 28.



(Industry report, DOMS, 2023)

India's stationery and art materials exports amounted to approximately INR 5,732 crore in the financial year 2023. The primary export categories were registers, notebooks, and letter pads, accounting for 36% of the total, followed by pens and related products at 34%. Other significant export items included painting supplies (15%), pencils and related products (7%), and paper (5%).

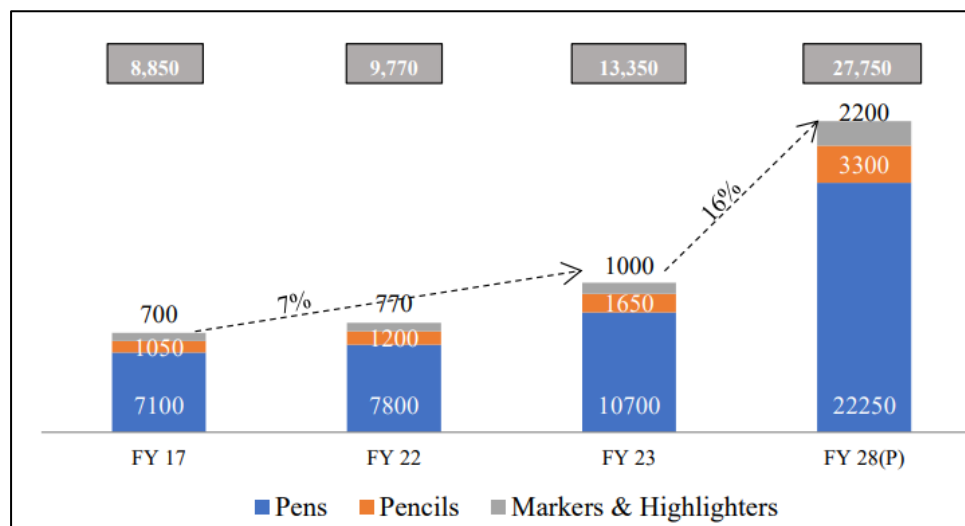
The United States was the largest export destination, capturing around 28% of the market, followed by the United Kingdom at 7%. The Indian stationery and art materials export market is projected to expand at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of approximately 6% from FY 2023 to FY 2028, reaching a value of INR 7,500 crore by the end of the forecast period.



Indian Writing Instrument Market

The Indian writing instrument market, comprising pens, pencils, markers, and highlighters, is currently valued at INR 13,350 crore. This sector is anticipated to grow significantly, reaching INR 27,750 crore by FY 28, representing a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of approximately 16%.

Pens dominate the market, accounting for 80% of the total value, primarily driven by high sales volume. Pencils hold a 12% share, while markers and highlighters contribute 8%. In terms of quantity, the market produced approximately 1,000 crore pens, 400 crore pencils, and 50 crore markers and highlighters in FY 23.



(Industry report, DOMS, 2023)

Pens in India are primarily categorized into three types: ballpoint, gel, and rollerball. Ballpoint pens dominate the market, holding a 68% share, followed by gel pens at 20% and rollerball pens at 12%.

Sub-Category	Market Share by Value in Indian Writing Instruments Industry	Product Type	Market Share by Value in sub-category
Pen	80%	Ballpoint	68%
		Gel	20%
		Rollerball	12%
Pencil	12%	Wooden	92%
		Polymer	7%
		Mechanical	1%
Markers and Highlighters	8%	-	-

Source – Secondary Research and Technopak Analysis

Based on price, pens are classified as mass market (up to INR 15), premium (INR 15-400), and super premium (above INR 400). The mass market segment, constituting 80% of the market, is driven by high volume sales, primarily to students and corporates. Competition in this segment is fierce, with price being a key factor.

The premium segment focuses on both volume and price, emphasizing design and branding to appeal to professionals and corporate gifting. The super-premium segment is driven by price, with a focus on luxury and prestige. International brands like Muji, Parker, and Montblanc are prominent players in the premium and super premium categories.

Segments	Price Points	Market Share by Value	Leading players
Mass market	Up to INR 15	80%	Linc, Flair, Cello
Premium	INR 15 – INR 400	16%	Luxor, Cello, Flair
Super Premium	>INR 400	4%	Parker, Montblanc

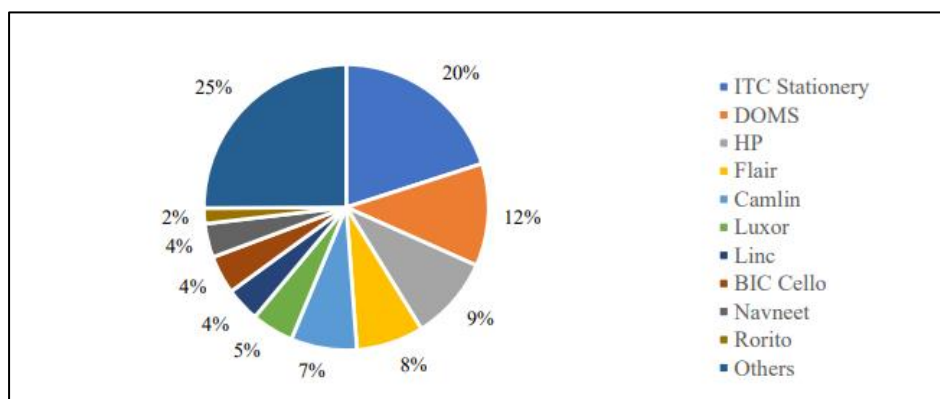
Source – Secondary Research and Technopak Analysis

Dominance of Branded Players in the Indian Stationery Market

Branded players hold a significant share of approximately 36% (INR 13,850 crore) in the Indian stationery and art materials market as of FY 23. Within this segment, ten key players, including ITC, Hindustan Pencils, DOMS, Camlin, Flair, Luxor, Linc, BIC Cello, Navneet, and Rorito, collectively control around 75% of the market. ITC emerges as the market leader with a 20% share, followed by DOMS at 12%, Hindustan Pencils at 9%, Flair at 8%, and Camlin at 7%.

The stationery and art materials industry is heavily reliant on distribution networks. DOMS, the second-largest branded player, exemplifies this with its extensive reach of 4,000+ distributors, 120+ super stockists, and over 120,000 retail outlets. DOMS' success is attributed to its diverse product portfolio, holding leadership positions in multiple product categories.

MARKET SHARE BY VALUE OF BRANDS 2023

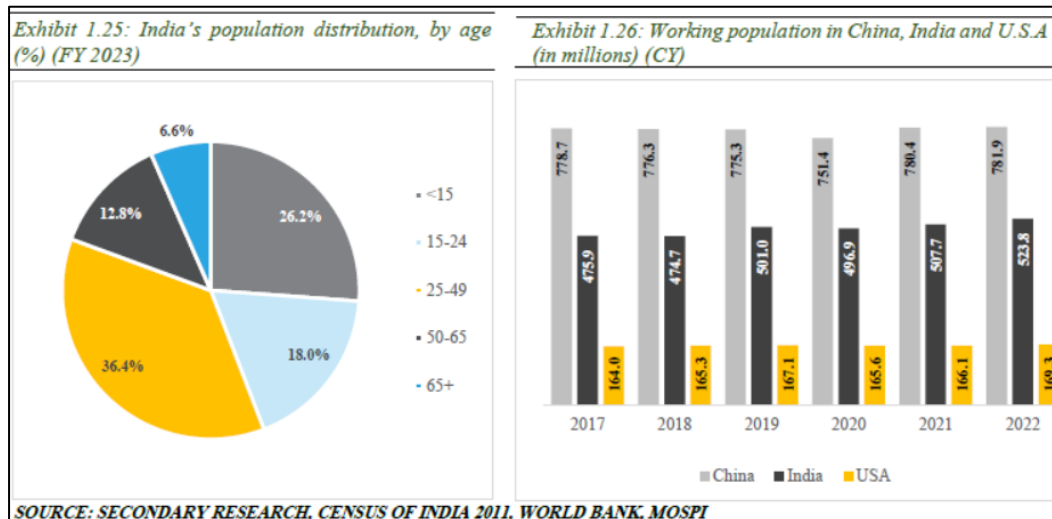


COMPANY FINANCIALS 2023

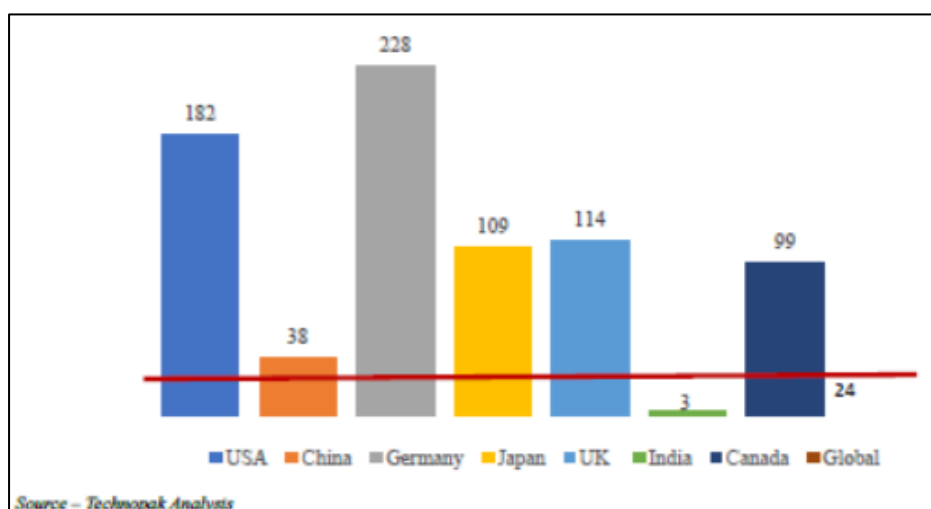
Player	Revenue (INR Crore)	Domestic Sales (INR Crore)	Export Sales (INR Crore)
DOMS	1,232	974	258
Kokuyo Camlin	775	742	33
Hindustan Pencils	1,100	955	150
Navneet	947	380	567
Luxor	490	475	14
Linc	487	386	101
Flair	943	758	185
Rorito	174	174	0
BIC Cello	550	429	121
ITC Stationery	2,456	2,010	446

Key Growth Drivers for the Indian Stationery Industry

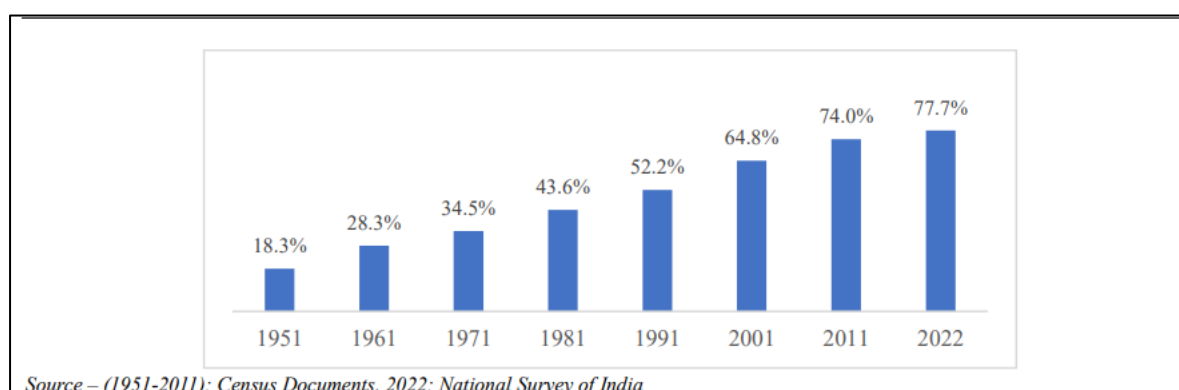
India boasts a youthful demographic, with approximately 26% of its population aged between 15 and 29, as per the "Youth in India 2022" report. Simultaneously, the working-age population (15-64 years) constitutes around 68% of the total, as of CY 22. This demographic profile significantly drives demand for both educational and office stationery.



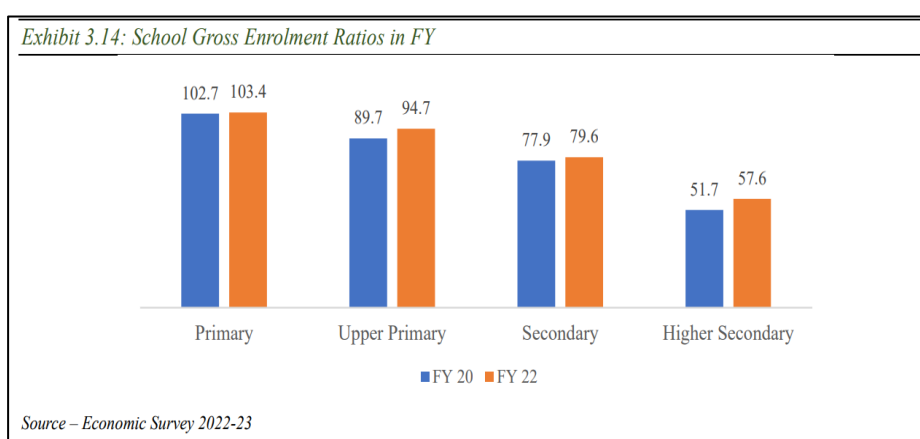
Consumer behavior has evolved, with individuals purchasing multiple stationery items at once. India's per capita stationery consumption currently stands at approximately US\$3 in CY 22, significantly lower than the global average of US\$24, indicating substantial growth potential. For instance, per capita pencil consumption in India is around 3 compared to 6 in the USA.



India's literacy rate has improved from 65% in CY 01 to 77.7% in CY 22, fueled by government initiatives like the New India Literacy Program, Right to Education Act, Sarva Siksha Abhiyan, and NIPUN Bharat Scheme. This, coupled with a high population growth rate, creates a vast consumer base for stationery products.



The Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) has risen from 102.7 in FY 20 to 103.4 in FY 22, with even more substantial increases in upper primary (89.7 to 94.7) and secondary levels (77.9 to 79.6). Higher secondary GER surged from 51.7 in FY 20 to 57.6 in FY 22. These figures, combined with the 14.9 lakh schools educating 26.5 crore students and 56,200 higher education institutes with 4.1 crore students, indicate a substantial expansion of the potential customer base for stationery products.



The private coaching industry, valued at INR 58,100 crores in CY 22 and projected to reach INR 1,34,000 crores by CY 28, is a burgeoning market for stationery products. Both students and coaching institutes contribute to this demand.

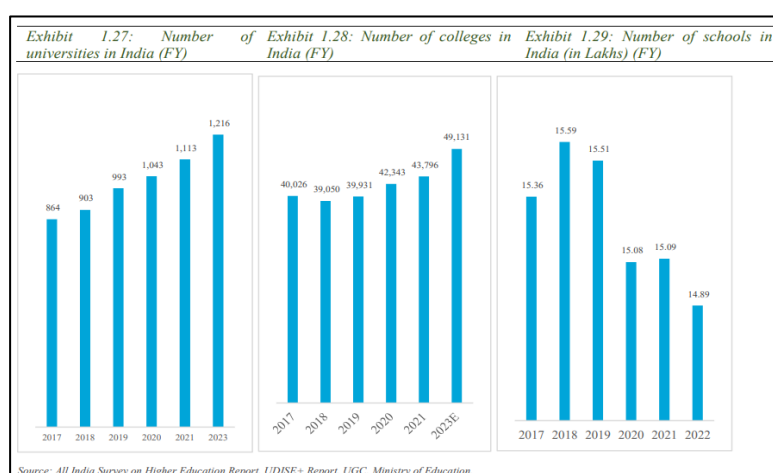
Corporate gifting and children's birthdays have fueled the demand for stationery items, particularly in the premium segment. Companies like DOMS and Kokuyo Camlin offer attractive combos and kits.

The education system in India is one among the largest compared to other countries in the world. This sector in India is expected to reach at INR 25 trillion by FY 28 from INR ~14 trillion in FY 2023, thus growing at a CAGR of 11.4 % during the forecasted period.

Over the past few years, there has been a substantial growth in the number of universities and colleges. The number of universities has doubled from 864 in FY17 to 1,216 in FY23, while colleges have increased from 40,026 in FY17 to an estimated 49,131 in FY23.

However, the number of schools has slightly decreased from 15.09 lakh in FY21 to 14.89 lakh in FY22. This decline is primarily attributed to the consolidation of government schools for better management and resource allocation, rather than an actual reduction in educational facilities.

To further enhance the quality of education, the government has introduced the PM SHRI Schools scheme with an investment of Rs. 27,360 crores over five years. This initiative aims to upgrade 14,500 schools nationwide with advanced infrastructure and teaching methodologies.



Impulse buying behavior, driven by factors like increasing disposable income and improving living standards, has also contributed to stationery market growth.

Government policy reforms, such as the National Education Policy 2020, Samagra Shiksha Scheme, and the New India Literacy Program, with a combined outlay of Rs 3,04,013 crores, are bolstering the education sector and consequently, the stationery market. Additionally, CSR initiatives by companies like ICICI Bank and Mahindra Group, impacting millions of students and teachers, are creating institutional demand for stationery products

9. About the company

ITC Limited, one of India's most prominent conglomerates, traces its roots back to 1910 when it was established as the Imperial Tobacco Company of India Limited. Over the years, as Indian ownership increased, the company underwent name changes to India Tobacco Company Limited in 1970 and subsequently to I.T.C. Limited in 1974. To reflect its diversified business portfolio, the company dropped the full stops from its name in 2001, becoming ITC Limited.

ITC repositions the Education and Stationery Products Business in 2008 and launches India's first environment-friendly premium business paper under the “PAPERKRAFT” brand. 'Vivel De Wills' and 'Vivel' range of soaps and shampoos are also launched.

10. Brief History of company

Early Years (1910-1970s)

- Founded as Imperial Tobacco Co. of India Ltd.
- Focused on manufacturing and distributing cigarettes, smoking tobaccos, and specialty papers.
- Entered the hotel business in the 1970s.

Diversification and Growth (1980s-2000s)

- ITC embarked on a significant diversification strategy, venturing into new businesses such as:
 - **Paperboards and specialty papers:** Established a strong presence in the paper industry.

- **Agri-business:** Entered the edible oils market and explored other agricultural products.
- **Information technology:** Launched ITC Infotech, a subsidiary focused on IT services.
- **Financial services:** Established a financial services division, later merged with ICICI.
- **Consumer goods:** Launched branded apparel (Wills Sport), greeting cards (Expressions PAPERKRAFT), food products (Aashirvaad atta, Sunfeast biscuits), and personal care items (Vivel shampoo).
- **Matches and agarbattis**
- **Hotels**
- **Real estate**

Recent Developments (2010s-2020s)

- Continued to focus on new product launches and brand building.
- Expanded its presence in existing businesses, such as paper manufacturing and food.
- Entered new markets like fairness creams and e-cigarettes.
- Acquired companies and expanded its operations.
- Focused on sustainability and corporate social responsibility initiatives.

11. Brief notes on Top Management

ITC Limited, a prominent Indian conglomerate, is led by a seasoned and experienced team. Here's a brief overview of some of its key members:

Sanjiv Puri is the Chairman & Managing Director of ITC. He has been instrumental in driving the company's growth and diversification.

Sumant Bhargavan oversees the Paperboards, Paper, and Packaging business. His expertise lies in the paper and packaging industry.

Supratim Dutta is the Executive Director & Chief Financial Officer. He is responsible for the company's financial strategy and reporting.

Hemant Malik heads the Foods Business Division, demonstrating his experience in the food industry.

Sandeep Kaul leads the ITD, Matches and Agarbatti Business, and ITC's Start-up Cell. His background in engineering and business management positions him well for these roles.

Anil Rajput heads ITC Corporate Affairs, overseeing the company's public relations and corporate social responsibility initiatives.

S Sivakumar oversees the Agri and IT Businesses, showcasing his expertise in these sectors. He also leads ITC's Social Investments Programme.

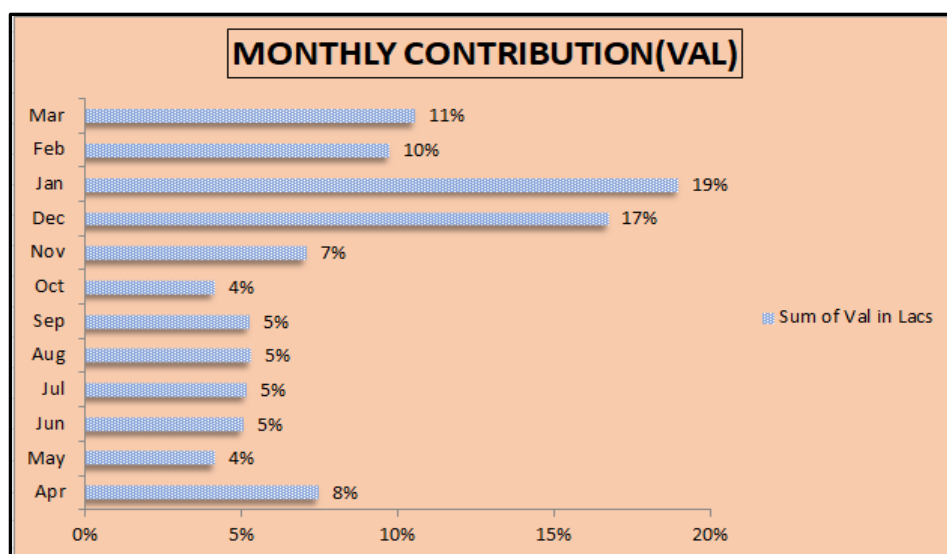
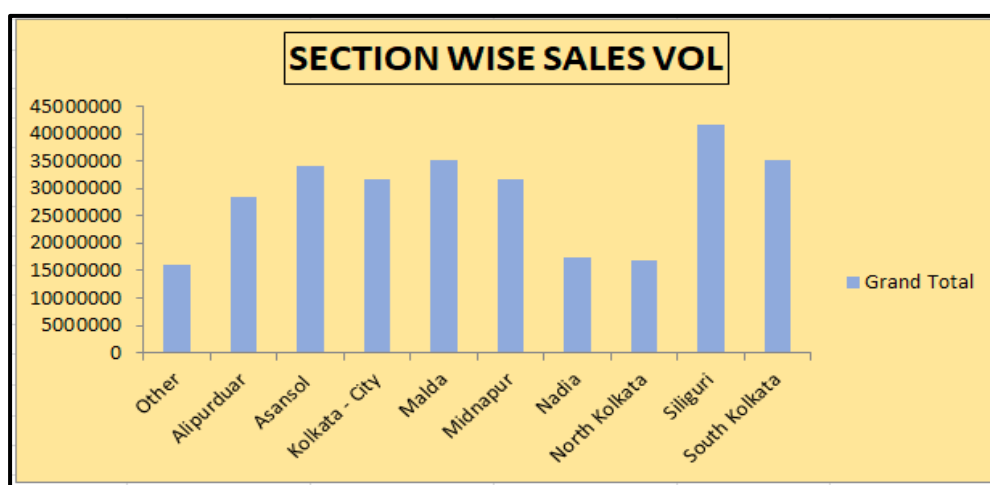
R K Singhi is the Executive Vice President & Company Secretary, ensuring compliance with corporate governance standards.

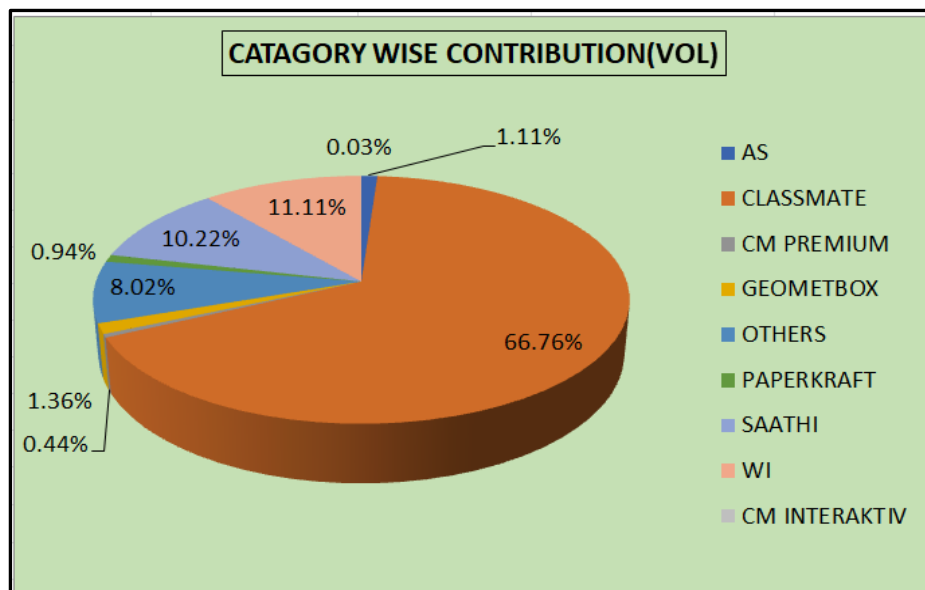
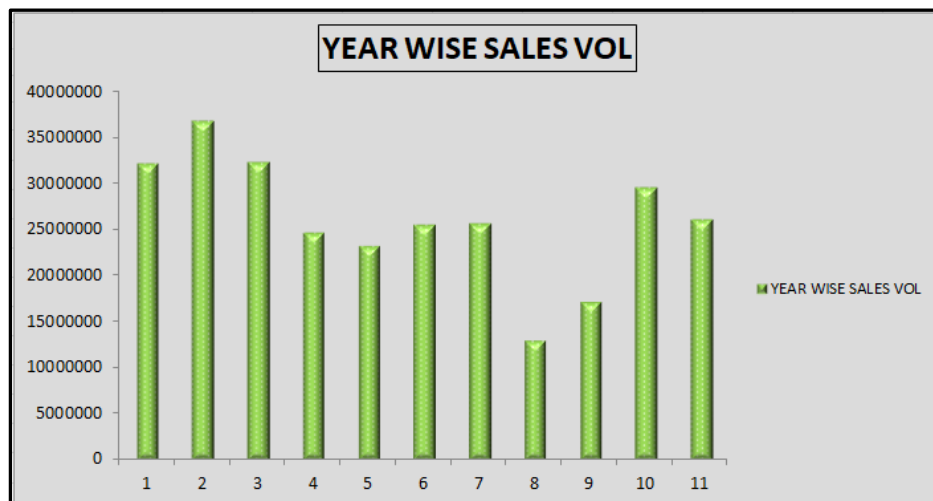
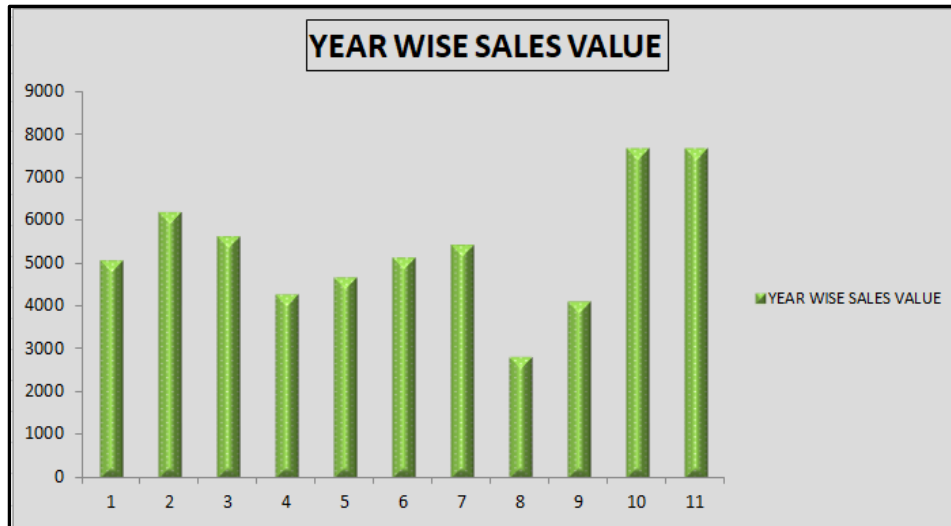
12. Companies Product / Service

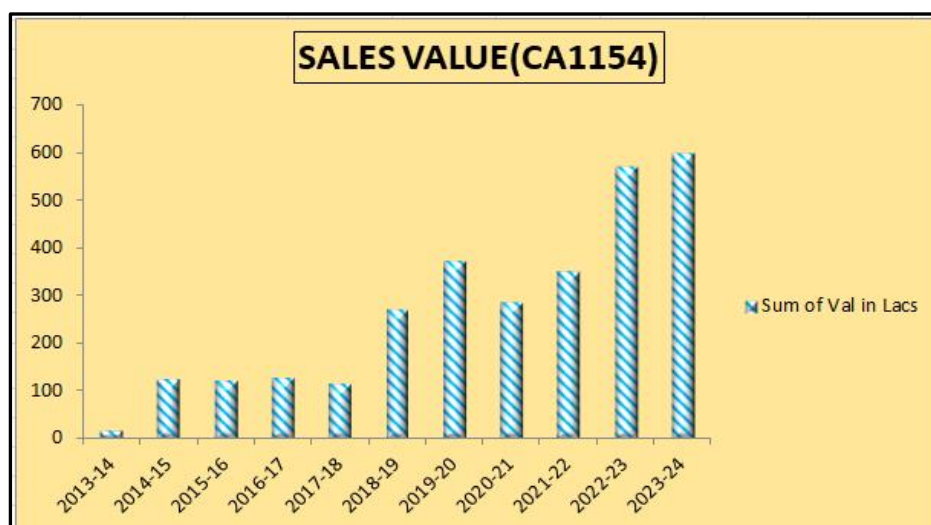
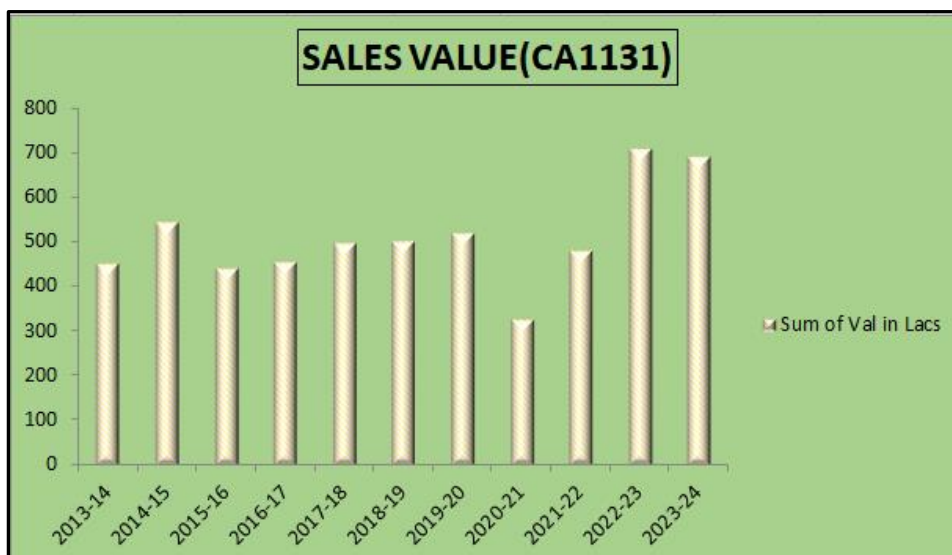
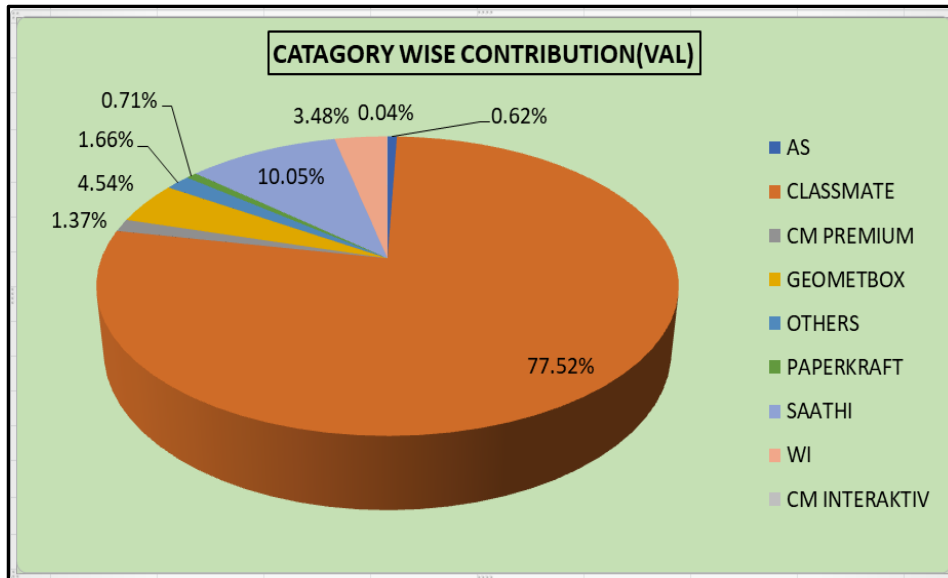
- i. **Fast Moving Consumer Goods (FMCG):** This is a major segment for ITC, encompassing food, personal care, cigarettes, cigars, education and stationery products, incense sticks, and safety matches.
- ii. **Hotels:** ITC owns and operates a chain of luxury and premium hotels across India.
- iii. **Paperboards and Packaging:** The company is a significant player in the paper and packaging industry.
- iv. **Agri-Business:** ITC has a substantial presence in agriculture, dealing with commodities like wheat, rice, spices, coffee, soya, and tobacco.
- v. **Information Technology:** The company offers IT services and solutions.

SEGMENTS	2020-21	% CONTRI	2021-22	% CONTRI	2022-23	% CONTRI	2023-24	% CONTRI
FMCG OTHERS	14728.12	27.33%	15994.49	24.77%	19122	24.78%	20967	26.65%
CIGARETTES	20333.12	37.73%	23451.39	36.32%	28207	36.55%	30597	38.88%
HOTEL	627.51	1.16%	1285	1.99%	2585	3.35%	2989	3.80%
AGRI	12582.24	23.35%	16196.07	25.08%	18173	23.55%	15792	20.07%
PAPER & PAPERBOARD	5618.55	10.43%	7641.62	11.83%	9082	11.77%	8345	10.60%
Total	53889.54		64568.57		77169		78690	
INTER-SEGMENT REVENUE	5738.39		5467.46		7687		9243	
GROSS REVENUE(CR.)	48151.15		59101.11		69482		69447	

ESPB data (West Bengal):







Interpretation:

- In last 11 years, Siliguri has the highest sales volume including all ESPB products followed by South Calcutta.
- In month wise contribution, the sales increases from the month of November and reaches to the pick in the month of January due to new admissions and education session. As per the data, May to October shows decrease in sales.
- Comparing the sales Value and sales volume, we can see that the sales value has increased while sales volume has decreased, interpreting which describes that the amount of the product has increased throughout the years while volume has gone down.
- In category wise contribution, Classmate notebooks are contributing the most in terms of volume and value both. Writing instruments is in the second position considering the sales volume though 'Sathi', a brand of classmate notebooks is in the 2nd position by sales value.
- Comparing both the distributors in Siliguri, the total sales value of CA1131 is approximately 7 CR and CA1154 is approximately 6.3 CR. CA1154 has shown rapid growth in sales value in last 10 years in comparing to CA1131.

13. Michael Porter Value Chain Analysis

PRIMARY ACTIVITIES

Inbound Logistics: ITC leverages its extensive distribution network of over 6,000 stockists and 1 million retail outlets to efficiently procure raw materials. The company's backward integration into agriculture, encompassing over 250,000 acres of farmland, ensures a steady supply of key inputs like wheat, rice, and paper pulp.

Operations: ITC operates over 35 large manufacturing facilities across India, producing a wide range of products. The company has invested heavily in technology and automation, resulting in a production capacity of approximately 100,000 tonnes of paper and paperboard annually.

Outbound Logistics: With a distribution network spanning across India, ITC ensures efficient product delivery to the vast consumer base. The company's fleet of over 6,000 vehicles and strategic warehousing facilities optimize distribution costs and reduce delivery time.

Marketing and Sales: ITC's annual advertising expenditure exceeds INR 2,000 crores, reflecting its commitment to brand building. The company employs a robust sales force of over 20,000 personnel to drive sales and market penetration.

After-sales Service: ITC operates a network of customer care centers to address consumer queries and complaints, aiming for a first-call resolution rate of over 90%.

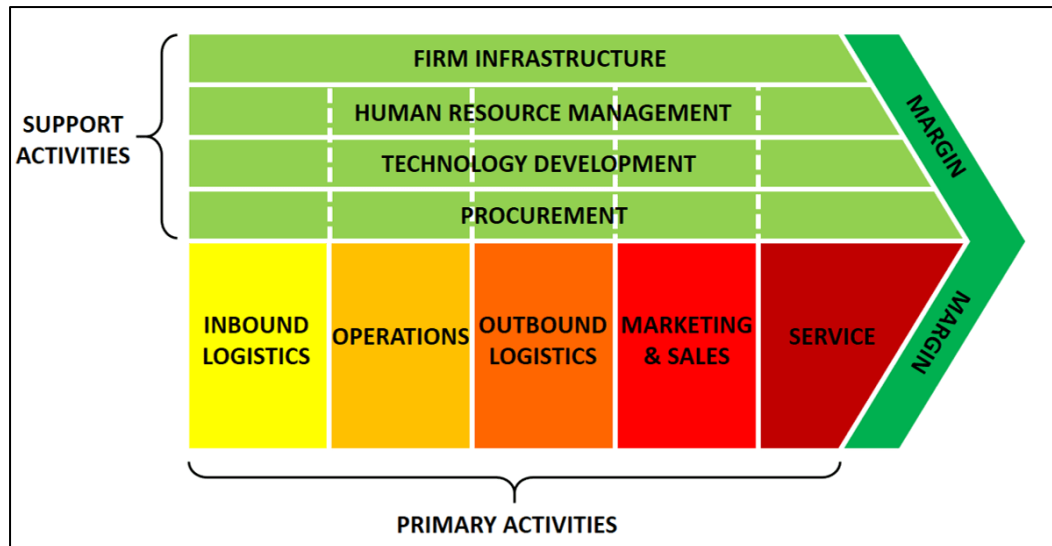
SUPPORT ACTIVITIES

Procurement: ITC's centralized procurement function manages annual purchases worth billions of rupees. The company's focus on sustainable sourcing and supplier development has resulted in long-term partnerships with key suppliers.

Human Resource Management: With a workforce of over 35,000 employees, ITC emphasizes talent development and employee engagement. The company has invested significantly in training and development programs to build a skilled workforce.

Technology: ITC's IT infrastructure supports end-to-end business operations, including supply chain management, manufacturing, sales, and marketing. The company has implemented advanced analytics tools to drive data-driven decision making.

Infrastructure: ITC's physical infrastructure, including manufacturing facilities, warehouses, and distribution centers, is strategically located to optimize operations and reduce costs. The company's investments in rural infrastructure, such as e-choupal initiatives, have strengthened its market reach.



14. Market Penetration of product / service Rural, Semi Urban & Urban

FMCG Products

Rural: 60-70% market penetration for popular brands like Aashirvaad, Sunfeast, and Vivel.

Semi-Urban: 75-85% market penetration for FMCG products.

Urban: 90-95% market penetration for FMCG products.

Paperboards and Specialty Papers

Rural: 40-50% market penetration, primarily for packaging materials used in local industries.

Semi-Urban: 60-70% market penetration, driven by local businesses and industries.

Urban: 80-90% market penetration, catering to a wider range of industries and businesses.

Hotels

Rural: Limited presence, with a focus on budget-friendly options.

Semi-Urban: Moderate presence, with mid-range hotels catering to business travelers and tourists.

Urban: Strong presence with luxury and premium hotels, targeting corporate travelers and leisure tourists.

15. Segment, Target & Positioning

ITC, a leading FMCG conglomerate, employs a strategic approach to identify and target specific consumer segments. By dividing the market into distinct groups based on various characteristics, ITC tailors its products and marketing efforts to meet diverse customer needs.

Market Segmentation involves categorizing consumers into groups based on factors such as age, gender, income, location, lifestyle, and buying behavior. For instance, ITC targets the youth with its Classmate products and caters to the urban working class with its Aashirvaad atta.

Target Market Selection focuses on identifying the most promising consumer segments based on factors like market size, growth potential, and profitability. ITC's emphasis on the growing urban middle class exemplifies this strategy.

Product Positioning involves creating a clear and compelling brand image in the minds of target consumers. ITC excels in positioning its brands to resonate with specific consumer needs and desires. Aashirvaad, for example, is positioned as a trusted and authentic Indian food brand, while Classmate is perceived as a reliable and affordable stationery option.

Classmate, a flagship brand under ITC's umbrella, has effectively segmented its target market:

SEGMENTATION

Demographic Segmentation: Primarily targeting students from pre-school to higher education, Classmate caters to a wide age group. Additionally, segmentation based on income levels helps in product differentiation.

Geographic Segmentation: With a pan-India presence, Classmate caters to diverse regional preferences and needs. However, specific product variations or marketing campaigns can be tailored to regional markets.

Behavioral Segmentation: Classmate focuses on students with high usage rates of stationery products, such as those preparing for exams or engaging in creative activities.

Psychographic Segmentation: The brand targets students who value quality, affordability, and durability in their stationery products.

TARGETING

Classmate primarily targets the student segment, which is a large and growing market in India. The brand has successfully positioned itself as a preferred choice for students across various socioeconomic backgrounds. By understanding the specific needs and preferences of different student segments, Classmate has been able to tailor its product offerings accordingly.

POSITIONING

Classmate has positioned itself as a reliable and affordable stationery brand. The brand emphasizes quality, durability, and innovation in its product range. Additionally, Classmate has successfully created a strong brand image through consistent marketing efforts and a wide distribution network. By offering a comprehensive range of stationery products, including notebooks, pens, pencils, and geometry boxes, Classmate has established itself as a one-stop shop for students' stationery needs.

16. Sales & Distribution Channels

ITC has established a robust distribution network to ensure wide reach and efficient product delivery.

Key distribution channels

Direct distribution: ITC operates approximately 3,500 ITC stores across India, providing a direct-to-consumer channel for its premium products.

Indirect distribution: the majority of ITC's products are distributed through an extensive network of:

Wholesalers: over 20,000 wholesalers are engaged to distribute products to smaller retailers, especially in rural areas.

Distributors: approximately 5,000 distributors manage specific geographic territories, ensuring product availability and effective market coverage.

Retailers: ITC products are available in over 6 million retail outlets, including traditional trade (kirana stores), modern trade (supermarkets, hypermarkets), and e-commerce platforms.

Distribution network strength

Geographic reach: ITC's distribution network covers over 90% of India's population, ensuring widespread product availability.

Inventory management: the company employs advanced inventory management systems to optimize stock levels and reduce out-of-stock situations.

Logistics efficiency: ITC's own fleet of over 6,000 vehicles, coupled with efficient warehousing facilities, ensures timely delivery of products.

Rural focus: the company has invested significantly in rural distribution, with a focus on reaching consumers in tier-II and tier-III cities.

17. Concept of Margin: GMROI & ROI of Product / Service

Product: Pen

Retail Price: Rs. 10

Wholesale Price: Rs. 7 (for quantities below 100) and Rs. 6.60 (for quantities above 100)

Margin:

The margin for retailers is already provided: 30% for quantities below 100 and 34% for quantities above 100.

Distributor 1:

Selling Value: Rs. 6.94 crore

Profit Percentage: 6%

Investment: Rs. 7.37 crore

Cost Percentage: 1.5%

Distributor 2:

Selling Value: Rs. 6 crore

Profit Percentage: 6%

Investment: Rs. 6.23 crore

Cost Percentage: 1.2%

ROI (Return on Investment):

$ROI = (Net\ Profit / Investment) * 100$

Distributor 1:

$Net\ Profit = Selling\ Value * Profit\ Percentage = Rs. 6.94\ crore * 6\% = Rs. 41.64\ lakh$

$Cost = Selling\ Value * Cost\ Percentage = Rs. 6.94\ crore * 1.5\% = Rs. 10.41\ lakh$

$Gross\ Profit = Selling\ Value - Cost = Rs. 6.94\ crore - Rs. 10.41\ lakh = Rs. 5.9\ crore$

$ROI = (Net\ Profit / Investment) * 100 = (Rs. 41.64\ lakh / Rs. 7.37\ crore) * 100 = 5.65\%$

Distributor 2:

$Net\ Profit = Selling\ Value * Profit\ Percentage = Rs. 6\ crore * 6\% = Rs. 36\ lakh$

$\text{Cost} = \text{Selling Value} * \text{Cost Percentage} = \text{Rs. 6 crore} * 1.2\% = \text{Rs. 7.2 lakh}$

$\text{Gross Profit} = \text{Selling Value} - \text{Cost} = \text{Rs. 6 crore} - \text{Rs. 7.2 lakh} = \text{Rs. 5.28 crore}$

$\text{ROI} = (\text{Net Profit} / \text{Investment}) * 100 = (\text{Rs. 36 lakh} / \text{Rs. 6.23 crore}) * 100 = 5.77\%$

18. Promotional Mix of Product

ITC employs a multi-faceted promotional mix to effectively reach its target audience and drive sales.

Advertising: ITC invests heavily in advertising, with an annual expenditure of over INR 2,000 crores. The company utilizes a mix of television, print, radio, and digital platforms to create impactful campaigns. For instance, the 'Aashirvaad Svasti' campaign has garnered significant attention and contributed to brand building.

Sales Promotions: ITC offers a variety of sales promotions, including discounts, coupons, and loyalty programs. The 'Happy Days' scheme has been successful in driving sales and increasing customer engagement.

Public Relations: ITC maintains a strong public relations function, with a focus on corporate social responsibility initiatives and crisis management. The company's association with the 'Clean India' campaign has enhanced its brand image.

Personal Selling: ITC's extensive sales force, comprising over 20,000 personnel, plays a crucial role in building relationships with trade partners and consumers.

Direct Marketing: The company utilizes direct marketing channels such as SMS, email, and telemarketing for targeted promotions and customer relationship management.

Digital Marketing: ITC has embraced digital platforms to connect with consumers. The company's social media campaigns and content marketing initiatives have garnered millions of followers and engagements.

19. Recent Merger & Acquisition

ITC, a diversified conglomerate, has been actively expanding its business portfolio through strategic acquisitions.

Expansion into the Food and Beverages Sector

In January 2023, ITC acquired SPROUTLIFE Foods, the parent company of Yoga Bar, a popular direct-to-consumer health and wellness brand. This move signifies ITC's strategic entry into the growing nutrition and health foods market.

More recently, in March 2024, ITC expressed its intent to acquire a substantial 47% stake in Prataap Snacks, renowned for its 'YELLOW DIAMOND CHIPS' brand. This potential acquisition would mark a significant step for ITC in the snacks segment, enabling it to tap into the growing demand for packaged snacks in India.

Strengthening the Digital Services Portfolio

Beyond the food and beverage sector, ITC has also focused on expanding its digital capabilities. In April 2024, ITC Infotech, a wholly-owned subsidiary of ITC, acquired Blazeclan Technologies. This acquisition is aimed at bolstering ITC Infotech's position in the cloud computing and digital transformation services market, enabling it to offer comprehensive IT solutions to its clients.

Demerger of Hotel Business

ITC Ltd., a diversified conglomerate, has announced plans to demerge its hotel division into a separate listed entity. This strategic move aims to unlock the full potential of the hospitality business, allowing for better management, valuation, and growth prospects. Post-demerger, ITC will retain a 40% stake in the newly formed hotel company, while the remaining 60% will be distributed to existing ITC shareholders. The demerger is expected to enhance shareholder value by providing investors with the option to invest directly in the hotel business.

20. SWOT – Company & Product / Service

ITC, a leading Indian conglomerate, operates in a dynamic market environment. A SWOT analysis, coupled with relevant data, provides a comprehensive understanding of the company's strategic position.

STRENGTHS

Diversified Portfolio: ITC's revenue from FMCG segment stood at Rs. 57,880 crore in FY23, contributing significantly to overall revenue.

Strong Brand Equity: ITC boasts a portfolio of strong brands like Aashirvaad, Sunfeast, and Classmate with high consumer trust and loyalty.

Extensive Distribution Network: With over 6,000 stockists and 1 million retail outlets, ITC enjoys a wide reach, especially in rural markets.

Financial Performance: ITC reported a revenue of Rs. 76,764 crore in FY23 with a net profit of Rs. 16,526 crore, reflecting its financial strength.

WEAKNESSES

Dependence on Tobacco: The tobacco division still contributes significantly to ITC's revenue, exposing it to regulatory risks.

Limited International Presence: Compared to global FMCG giants, ITC's international operations are relatively small.

OPPORTUNITIES

Growing FMCG Market: India's rising disposable income and growing middle class offer significant growth opportunities for ITC's FMCG business.

Digital Transformation: Leveraging digital technologies to enhance customer engagement, supply chain efficiency, and new business models.

Rural Market Expansion: Further penetrating the rural market through affordable and relevant product offerings.

THREATS

Intense Competition: The FMCG industry is highly competitive with both domestic and global players vying for market share.

Economic Slowdowns: Economic downturns can impact consumer spending and affect ITC's sales.

Changing Consumer Preferences: Evolving consumer tastes and preferences require continuous product innovation and adaptation.

Regulatory Challenges: The FMCG industry is subject to various regulations, which can impact operations and profitability.

21. BCG Matrix

The Boston Consulting Group (BCG) Matrix is a strategic management tool used to classify a company's products or business units into four categories based on their market share and market growth rate. It helps businesses allocate resources effectively and make strategic decisions about their portfolio.

The Four Quadrants of the BCG Matrix

Stars: High market share, high market growth. These are the company's most promising products, generating significant revenue and requiring substantial investment to maintain growth.

Cash Cows: High market share, low market growth. These products generate strong cash flow but face limited growth opportunities. They are often used to fund other business units.

Question Marks: Low market share, high market growth. These products have potential but require significant investment to increase market share. They are often risky but can become stars with successful strategies.

Dogs: Low market share, low market growth. These products generate little revenue and have limited growth prospects. They are often considered candidates for divestment or liquidation.

BCG Matrix for ITC limited:

Cigarettes: This business unit is typically classified as a cash cow. It generates substantial cash flow with a dominant market share, despite facing regulatory challenges.

FMCG (excluding cigarettes): ITC's FMCG business, encompassing brands like Aashirvaad, Sunfeast, and Classmate, can be categorized as a mix of stars (high growth, high market share) and question marks (high growth, low market share). Products like Classmate might be considered stars, while newer product lines could be question marks.

Hotels: ITC's hotel business, represented by ITC Hotels, is often classified as a star due to its strong brand reputation, growth potential, and increasing market share in the luxury segment.

Paperboards and Packaging: This business unit is typically considered a cash cow due to its stable market share and consistent cash generation.

Agri-Business: Given its growth potential and strategic importance, ITC's agri-business can be classified as a question mark.

ITC Infotech: As a relatively new business unit, ITC Infotech is likely positioned as a question mark due to its high growth potential and competitive market.

22. 4P's / 7P's Marketing Mix

PRODUCT

Diverse Portfolio: ITC offers over 2000 products across various categories, including FMCG, hospitality, paperboards, and agri-business.

Revenue: FMCG segment contributes significantly to overall revenue, with products like AASHIRVAAD Atta, SUNFEAST biscuits, and Classmate stationery being major contributors.

PRICE

Multi-tiered Pricing: ITC employs a pricing strategy to cater to different market segments. For instance, premium brands like Wills Lifestyle target the high-end segment, while products like AASHIRVAAD focus on affordability.

Average Price Realization: ITC's average price realization has been steadily increasing due to premiumization efforts and focus on value-added products.

PLACE

Distribution Network: ITC boasts a robust distribution network with over 6,000 stockists and 1 million retail outlets, ensuring widespread reach.

Rural Focus: The company has invested significantly in rural distribution, reaching over 60% of Indian villages.

PROMOTION

Advertising Spend: ITC invests heavily in advertising, with an annual expenditure of over INR 2,000 crores across television, print, radio, and digital platforms.

Sales Promotions: The company offers various sales promotions, such as discounts, coupons, and loyalty programs, to stimulate demand.

Digital Marketing: ITC has a strong online presence, with millions of followers on social media platforms and a robust e-commerce platform.

23. PLC

The product life cycle (PLC) is a concept that describes the stages a product goes through from its introduction to the market until it's eventually removed from the market. It's a tool used in marketing to understand a product's life cycle and develop appropriate strategies for each stage.

I. INTRODUCTION STAGE

Market: New product, limited awareness.

Sales: Low sales volume, often negative profits due to high development and launch costs.

Competition: Minimal competition.

Marketing Focus: Creating awareness, building brand image, educating consumers about the product.

Pricing: Skimming or penetration pricing strategies might be used.

II. GROWTH STAGE

Market: Increasing market acceptance, growing customer base.

Sales: Rapidly increasing sales, profits start to rise.

Competition: Competitors start to enter the market.

Marketing Focus: Expanding distribution channels, building brand loyalty, differentiating the product.

Pricing: Prices might stabilize or slightly decrease to capture a larger market share.

III. MATURITY STAGE

Market: Saturated market, slowing sales growth.

Sales: Sales peak and start to decline gradually.

Competition: Intense competition with established rivals.

Marketing Focus: Defending market share, product line extensions, and modifications.

Pricing: Competitive pricing, promotions, and discounts to maintain market share.

IV. DECLINE STAGE

Market: Shrinking market, decreasing demand.

Sales: Rapid decline in sales, profits dropping significantly.

Competition: Reduced competition as weaker players exit the market.

Marketing Focus: Reducing marketing expenditures, harvesting remaining profits, or phasing out the product.

Pricing: Lower prices to liquidate remaining inventory.

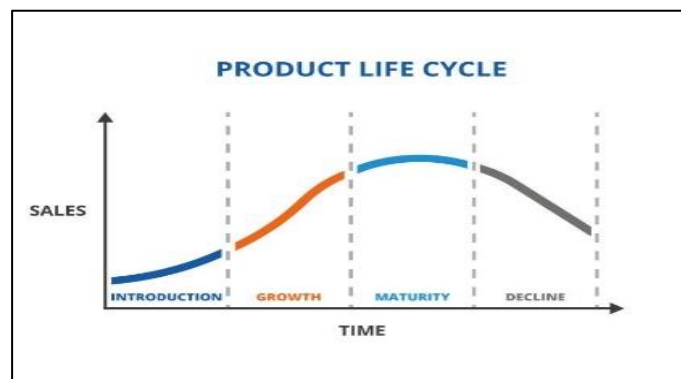
ITC Products: Classmate and PAPERKRAFT

CLASSMATE:

Given its long-standing presence in the market, consistent sales, and various product lines, the brand Classmate is in the maturity stage of the product life cycle. ITC focuses on maintaining market share, introducing new product variants, and promoting brand loyalty.

PAPERKRAFT:

As a relatively newer product line, PAPERKRAFT is in the growth stage of the product life cycle. ITC should invest in marketing and promotion to increase brand awareness and expand its customer base. The focus is on building market share and generating profits.



24. Product / Service -Unique Selling Propositions

FMCG (Fast-Moving Consumer Goods):

- **Aashirvaad:** Known for its quality, purity, and authenticity, Aashirvaad is a trusted brand in the staples market.
- **Sunfeast:** Offers a wide variety of biscuits, snacks, and noodles, catering to different tastes and preferences.
- **Vivel:** Emphasizes natural ingredients and skin-nourishing properties, positioning itself as a premium personal care brand.

- **Engage:** Known for its long-lasting fragrance and stylish packaging, Engage is a popular deodorant brand.

Paperboards and Specialty Papers:

- **Quality and Sustainability:** ITC's paperboards and specialty papers are recognized for their high quality and commitment to sustainability.
- **Customizable Solutions:** The company offers customized solutions to meet the specific needs of its customers in various industries.

Hotels:

- **Luxury and Hospitality:** ITC Hotels are renowned for their luxurious accommodations, impeccable service, and world-class amenities.
- **Unique Experiences:** Each ITC hotel offers unique experiences and cultural immersion, such as ITC Grand Chola's heritage zone and ITC Maurya's royal ambiance.

Agri-Business:

- **Sustainability and Ethical Sourcing:** ITC's agri-business division focuses on sustainable farming practices and ethical sourcing of agricultural products.
- **Value-Added Products:** The company offers value-added products like branded food items and organic produce.

25. The McKinsey 7S Framework

1.Strategy

- **Diversification:** ITC's strategy of diversifying into various sectors, including FMCG, hotels, paperboards, and IT services, has been successful in mitigating risks and capturing growth opportunities.
- **Market Leadership:** The company has established a strong market position in several sectors, particularly cigarettes and FMCG.

- **Sustainability Focus:** ITC's emphasis on sustainability and corporate social responsibility has enhanced its brand reputation and attracted environmentally conscious consumers.

2. Structure

- **Decentralized Structure:** ITC's decentralized structure allows for greater flexibility and responsiveness to market changes. However, it can also lead to potential coordination challenges between different business units.
- **Organizational Efficiency:** The company has been working on improving its organizational efficiency and streamlining processes to enhance operational effectiveness.

3. Systems

- **Technology Adoption:** ITC has invested in technology to improve its operations, supply chain management, and customer experience.
- **Digital Transformation:** The company has been actively pursuing digital transformation initiatives to stay competitive in the evolving market.

4. Style

- **Employee-Centric Culture:** ITC fosters a culture that values employees and their well-being. This can lead to increased employee engagement and productivity.
- **Innovation-Driven:** The company encourages innovation and creativity among its employees, fostering a culture of continuous improvement.

5. Staff

- **Skilled Workforce:** ITC has a highly skilled and experienced workforce, which is a key asset for the company's success.
- **Talent Development:** The company invests in employee development and training to ensure that its staff has the necessary skills and knowledge.

6. Skills

- **Diverse Skill Set:** ITC's employees possess a wide range of skills, from marketing and finance to technology and operations.
- **Skill Development:** The company focuses on developing the skills of its employees to meet the evolving needs of the business.

7. Shared Values

- **Sustainability:** ITC's commitment to sustainability has been recognized by various organizations and stakeholders.
- **Social Responsibility:** The company's social responsibility initiatives have helped build a positive brand image and strengthen relationships with communities.

26. Hypothesis Development (if any)

Hypothesis 1

- **Null Hypothesis (H0):** There is no significant relationship between the occupation of the consumer and the brand awareness of PAPERKRAFT pens.
- **Alternative Hypothesis (H1):** There is a significant relationship between the occupation of the consumer and the brand awareness of PAPERKRAFT pens.

Hypothesis 2

- **Null Hypothesis (H0):** The purpose of buying a premium pen does not influence the choice of premium pen brand.
- **Alternative Hypothesis (H1):** The purpose of buying a premium pen influences the choice of premium pen brand.

Hypothesis 3

- **Null Hypothesis (H0):** There is no significant relationship between the choice of premium pen and the budget range of consumers.

- Alternative Hypothesis (H1): There is a significant relationship between the choice of premium pen and the budget range consumers.

Hypothesis 4

- Null Hypothesis (H0): There is no significant relationship between the store size and the availability of PAPERKRAFT pens.

Alternative Hypothesis (H1): There is a significant relationship between the store size and the availability of PAPERKRAFT pens.

Chapter 3: Design and Methodology

1. Introduction

The PAPERKRAFT pen, a flagship product under ITC's ESPB division, faces challenges in establishing a strong foothold in the competitive Siliguri market. Characterized by low market demand and intense competition from premium brands, PAPERKRAFT seeks to understand the underlying factors hindering its growth. This research endeavours to illuminate the consumer and retailer landscape in Siliguri, providing valuable insights to optimize PAPERKRAFT's market strategy.

By delving into consumer preferences, purchase behaviour, and brand perception, this study aims to identify opportunities for enhancing PAPERKRAFT's brand positioning. Concurrently, an exploration of retailer perspectives on product assortment, stocking decisions, and consumer demands will shed light on distribution challenges and potential solutions. Ultimately, the findings of this research will serve as a catalyst for developing effective strategies to increase market share and drive sales for PAPERKRAFT pens in the Siliguri region.

2. Research Objective

The primary objective of this research is to gain a comprehensive understanding of the factors influencing consumer purchase decisions and retailer stocking behaviours for PAPERKRAFT

pens in the Siliguri market. By achieving this, the study aims to identify key opportunities for enhancing PAPERKRAFT's market position and driving sales growth.

MANAGEMENT OBJECTIVE:

To identify the primary factors influencing consumer purchase decisions of PAPERKRAFT pens and positioning among retailers in Siliguri market.

RESEARCH OBJECTIVE

R.O 1 - To identify the primary factors influencing consumer purchase decisions of PAPERKRAFT pen.

R.O 2 - To assess brand awareness, perception, and positioning of PAPERKRAFT pen among retailers.

R.O 3 - To identify key competitors of ESPB division and analyse their market positioning in the Siliguri market.

R.O 4 - To develop recommendations for improving PAPERKRAFT's market share and profitability in the Siliguri market.

3. Research Design

A descriptive research design was employed for this study to provide a comprehensive understanding of consumer and retailer perceptions towards PAPERKRAFT pens in the Siliguri market. Both quantitative and qualitative research methods were utilized to gather data from a diverse range of respondents.

Quantitative Research:

Surveys: Structured questionnaires were administered to a sample of students, professionals, and retailers to collect numerical data on brand awareness, purchase behaviour, product preferences, and retailer stocking patterns.

Statistical Analysis: Statistical techniques such as frequency analysis, cross-tabulation, and correlation analysis were employed to identify patterns, trends, and relationships within the data.

Qualitative Research:

In-depth Interviews: Open-ended interviews were conducted with a select group of retailers to gain deeper insights into their experiences with PAPERKRAFT pens, challenges faced, and suggestions for improvement.

Focus Group Discussions: Group discussions were held with students and professionals to explore their perceptions, preferences, and buying behaviour in detail.

4. Research Methodology

Value Gap identification

The core challenge facing PAPERKRAFT is a pronounced disparity between its market performance and that of its competitors. Despite being a product within the well-established ITC portfolio, PAPERKRAFT has struggled to gain significant market traction. This underperformance is primarily attributed to a confluence of factors:

Low Brand Awareness: A fundamental issue is the limited visibility and recognition of the PAPERKRAFT brand among both retailers and the end consumer. This lack of awareness translates into a diminished preference for PAPERKRAFT over established competitors.

Weak Retailer Relationships: The research indicates a clear disinclination among retailers to stock and promote PAPERKRAFT pens. This could be due to various factors such as low profit margins, limited consumer demand, or a perception of the product as a less profitable option compared to competitors.

Sales Performance Shortfall: The low sales volume of PAPERKRAFT pens is a direct consequence of the aforementioned challenges. The combination of low brand awareness and retailer apathy has resulted in suboptimal sales figures.

Crystallization of the Problem

Dependent Variable

The primary dependent variable in this research is the retailer's decision to stock and promote PAPERKRAFT pens. This decision is influenced by a combination of factors, as discussed in the previous section.

Independent Variables

The independent variables that impact the retailer's decision can be categorized into several groups:

- Product-related Factors:
 - Product features (design, quality, functionality)
 - Price
 - Product range and variety
 - Product availability
- Market-related Factors:
 - Brand reputation and awareness
 - Consumer demand
 - Market trends
 - Seasonality
- Retailer-centric Factors:
 - Profit margins
 - Schemes and incentives offered by the company
 - Benefits (credit, transportation) offered by the company
 - Retailer profile (independent vs. chain store)

5. Questionnaire design - Adapted or Developed

Three distinct questionnaires were developed to gather data from different respondent groups: students and professionals, retailers, and a combined group for factor analysis and attribute-based perceptual mapping.

Questionnaire 1: Students and Professionals

Demographics: Age, gender, occupation, education level, and income.

Pen Usage: Frequency of pen usage, preferred pen type, and brand awareness.

PAPERKRAFT Awareness: Knowledge of PAPERKRAFT pens, sources of information, and perceptions.

Purchase Behaviour: Factors influencing pen purchase decisions, price sensitivity, and brand loyalty.

Questionnaire 2: Retailers.

Demographic: Store size, location, and years in business.

Product Assortment: Range of pen brands offered, stocking decisions, and sales performance.

PAPERKRAFT Performance: Sales of PAPERKRAFT pens, customer demand, and challenges faced.

Competitor Analysis: Perception of competitors, price comparison, and promotional activities.

Questionnaire 3: Retailers.

Retailer Demographics: Store name, location.

Product Evaluation: Rating of PAPERKRAFT pens, competitor brands, and other stationery products on various attributes (price, quality, brand image, availability, etc.) using a Likert scale.

6. Unit of Analysis

The unit of analysis for this research is the individual. Specifically, the study focuses on two primary groups:

Consumers: Students and professionals who represent the target market for PAPERKRAFT pens.

Retailers: Business owners or managers of retail outlets that sell stationery products, including PAPERKRAFT pens.

By examining the perceptions, behaviours, and experiences of these two groups, the research aims to gain insights into the factors influencing the demand for and distribution of PAPERKRAFT pens in the Siliguri market.

7. Sample size

Determining the optimal sample size for a research study involves several considerations, including the desired level of precision, population size, and available resources. For this research, a sample size of 100 students and professionals and 160 retailers was determined based on practical constraints and the need to obtain a representative sample of the target population.

It is important to note that while this sample size provides a reasonable basis for analysis, it may not be fully representative of the entire population of students, professionals, and retailers in the Siliguri market. Therefore, the findings of this study should be interpreted with caution and generalized with care.

8. Data collection process

Data collection for this research involved a multi-step process to gather both quantitative and qualitative information.

Data Collection for Surveys

- **Questionnaire Distribution:** Questionnaires were distributed to students, professionals, and retailers in the Siliguri area through a combination of in-person visits, online platforms, and physical distribution at retail outlets.
- **Data Collection:** Completed questionnaires were collected through various methods, including in-person submission, online submissions, and mail returns.

Data Collection for Interviews and Focus Groups

- **Respondent Recruitment:** Participants for interviews and focus groups were recruited based on specific criteria, such as occupation, age, and purchasing behaviour.
- **Data Collection:** Interviews were conducted face-to-face or over the phone, while focus groups were conducted in a controlled environment. The discussions were audio-recorded and transcribed for analysis.

Data Management

- **Data Entry:** Quantitative data from surveys was entered into a spread sheet or statistical software for analysis.
- **Data Transcription:** Audio recordings of interviews and focus groups were transcribed verbatim for qualitative analysis.
- **Data Cleaning:** Collected data was cleaned and checked for errors, inconsistencies, and missing values.

9. Type of data used

This research employed both primary and secondary data to provide a comprehensive understanding of the consumer and retailer landscape for PAPERKRAFT pens in the Siliguri market.

Primary Data

Primary data was collected directly from the target audience through surveys, interviews, and focus groups. This data offered first-hand insights into consumer preferences, retailer experiences, and market dynamics.

Secondary Data

Secondary data was obtained from external sources such as industry reports, market research studies, and internal company records. This data provided a broader context for the research by offering information on market trends, consumer behaviour patterns, and competitive landscape.

10. Statistical Tools used with Justification

The choice of statistical tools depends on the specific research questions and the nature of the data collected. For this research, the following statistical techniques were employed:

Descriptive Statistics

- Frequency distributions: To summarize the distribution of variables such as age, gender, occupation, and product usage.
- Measures of central tendency (mean, median, mode): To describe the typical value of variables.
- Measures of dispersion (standard deviation, variance): To assess the variability of data.

Inferential Statistics

- Chi-square test: To analyse the relationship between categorical variables, such as the association between product usage and brand preference.
- Correlation analysis: To examine the relationship between continuous variables, such as the correlation between income and spending on stationery products.
- Regression analysis: To predict the impact of independent variables (e.g., price, brand image) on dependent variables (e.g., purchase intention).

Factor Analysis

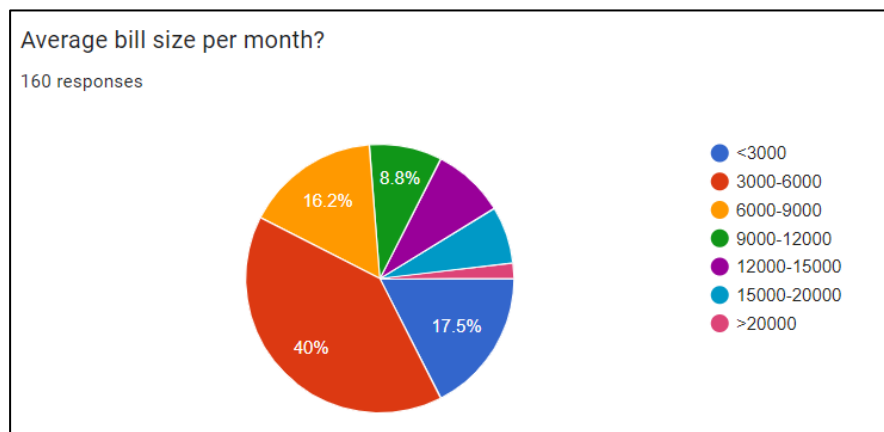
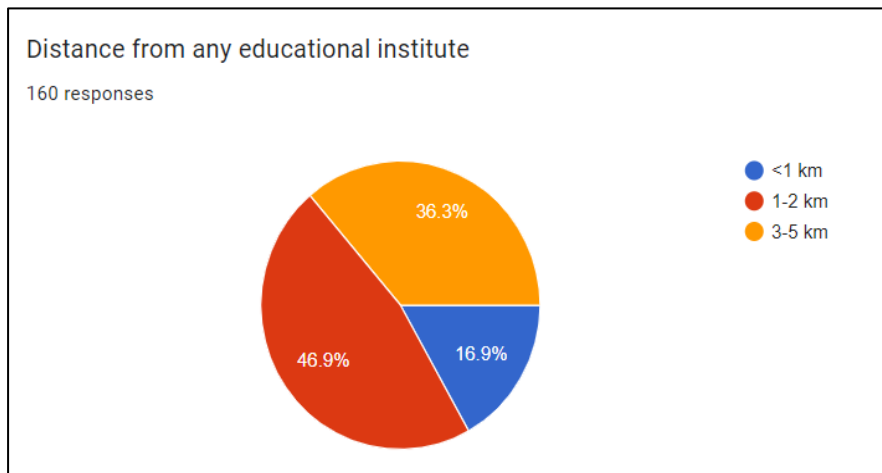
Factor analysis is a statistical technique used to reduce the number of variables in a dataset while retaining as much information as possible. In this research, it can be used to identify underlying factors that influence retailer purchase decisions from a list of variables such as price, availability, brand reputation, schemes, company benefits, and seasonality.

Attribute-Based Perceptual Mapping (ABPM)

ABPM is a technique used to visualize the perception of brands or products in the minds of consumers based on specific attributes. In this research, it can be used to position PAPERKRAFT pens relative to competitors like Parker and Pierre Cardin based on attributes like price, availability, market demand, brand reputation, schemes, company benefits, and seasonality.

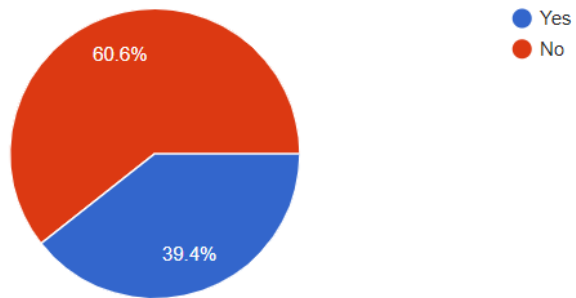
Chapter 4: Data Analysis and Findings

1. Demographic Profile of the respondents



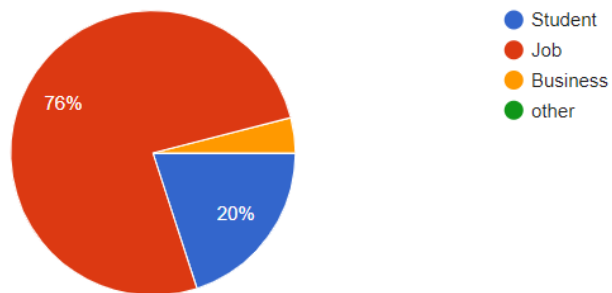
PAPERCRAFT PEN AVAILABILITY?

160 responses



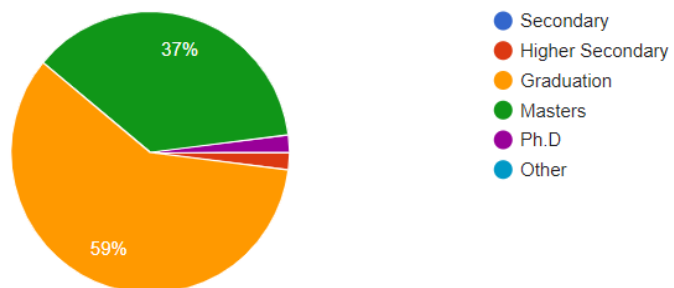
Occupation

100 responses



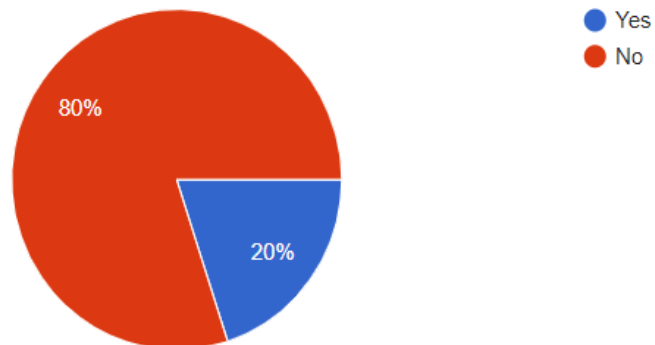
Education

100 responses



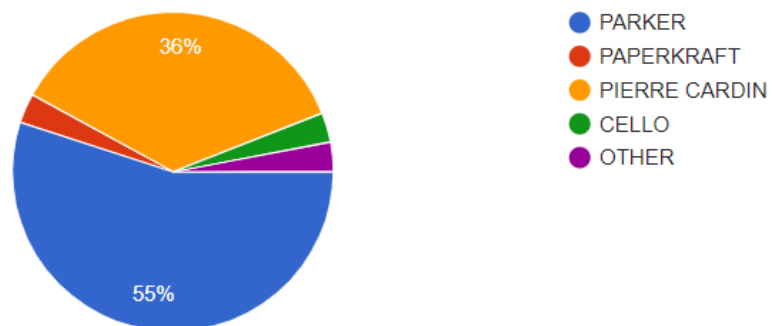
Do you know the brand "PAPERKRAFT"?

100 responses



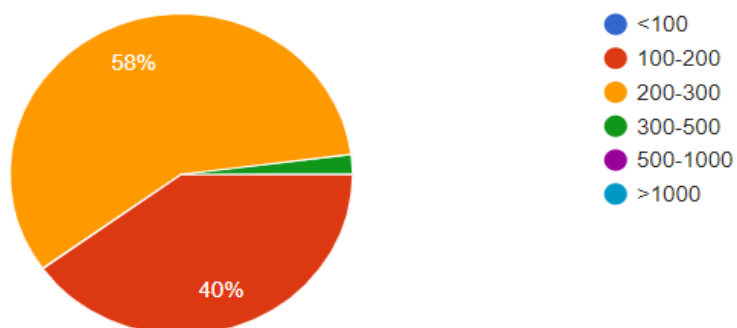
Which premium quality pen you will buy if you have a choice?

100 responses



What will be your budget range?

100 responses



INTERPRETATION:

- According to the respondents, 46.9% retail shops situated within 1-2 Km.
- 40% respondents are saying that Average bill size per months belongs to 3000 to 6000 followed by average bill size per month is less than 3000.
- In Siliguri, Papercraft pen availability is very high. 60% respondents are saying that PAPERKRAFT pen availability is very high in the locality.
- Maximum respondents are doing Job.
- Respondents have their great education profile. Maximum respondents have done their graduation.
- PAPERKRAFT brand awareness is low. 20% respondents are known about the brand.
- 55% respondents choose Parker as a premium quality pen to buy.
- 58% respondents are saying that their budget range is around 200 to 300.

2. Descriptive Statistics with competitor analysis:

To assess the competitive landscape and identify potential areas of opportunity, a comprehensive analysis was conducted on four key product categories: premium notebooks, pens, geometry boxes, and PAPERKRAFT pens. Data was collected from retailers through a structured survey, wherein they evaluated these products across dimensions such as price, margin, stock availability, sales volume, overall availability, market demand, and promotional schemes. A 5-point Likert scale was employed for ratings, with 1 representing the lowest and 5 the highest evaluation.

Descriptive statistics were utilized to analyze the collected data. Mean scores were calculated to determine the average perception of each product across the specified variables. Standard deviation was employed to measure the dispersion of ratings around the mean, indicating the degree of variability in retailer opinions.

A higher mean score for a particular product on a given variable suggests a generally favorable perception among retailers. Conversely, a lower mean score indicates a less favorable perception. A low standard deviation implies a relatively consistent perception of the product, while a high standard deviation signifies diverse opinions among retailers.

WRITING INSTRUMENTS (10 Rs. PEN):

PARAMETERS		CLASSMATE	HAUSER	CELLO	DOMS	LINC
BRAND VALUE	Mean	3.813	4.844	4.788	4.419	4.825
	N	160	160	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.5848	.3642	.4104	.7135	.3812
DESIGN & LOOKS	Mean	3.775	4.481	4.000	4.819	4.244
	N	160	160	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.6817	.5012	.5494	.4024	.4307
MARGIN PROVIDED	Mean	3.625	4.319	4.538	4.813	4.288
	N	160	160	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.7503	.4675	.5002	.3915	.4540
MARKET DEMAND	Mean	3.175	4.738	4.169	4.425	4.838
	N	160	160	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.3812	.4976	.3757	.5887	.3701
SELL PM	Mean	3.150	4.531	3.394	4.019	4.456
	N	160	160	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.3582	.5197	.7190	.6532	.7341
STOCK	Mean	3.563	4.513	4.063	4.050	4.113
	N	160	160	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.6700	.7438	.5794	.5355	.5493
WRITING EXP	Mean	3.975	4.663	4.075	4.438	4.863
	N	160	160	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.5373	.4874	.5887	.5223	.3455
Total	Mean	3.582	4.498	4.146	4.499	4.518
	N	1120	1120	1120	1120	1120
	Std. Deviation	.6511	.5741	.6777	.6053	.5653

PREMIUM NOTEBOOKS:

PARAMETERS		CLASSMATE	LUXOR	DOMS	CAMLIN
DESIGN & LOOKS	Mean	4.288	4.138	4.100	3.881
	N	160	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.6765	.8794	.7705	.6078
MARGIN PROVIDED	Mean	4.169	3.631	4.388	3.725
	N	160	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.7948	.7407	.7688	.6339
MARKET DEMAND	Mean	4.250	3.819	4.056	3.588
	N	160	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.7093	.8532	.8919	.8496
QUALITY	Mean	4.188	4.006	4.569	3.900
	N	160	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.7198	.9680	.5894	.8482
SELL PM	Mean	4.588	3.769	4.256	3.819
	N	160	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.5651	.8105	.8184	.8232
STOCK LEVEL	Mean	4.463	3.806	4.381	3.631
	N	160	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.6719	.9007	.6902	.6503
Total	Mean	4.324	3.861	4.292	3.757
	N	960	960	960	960
	Std. Deviation	.7077	.8752	.7792	.7507

PREMIUM PENS:

PARAMETERS		PARKER	PIERRE CARDIN	PAPERKRAFT
AVAILABILITY	Mean	4.090	4.197	3.656
	N	61	61	61
	Std. Deviation	1.2043	.8996	.5928
COMPANY BENEFIT	Mean	4.123	4.090	4.025
	N	61	61	61
	Std. Deviation	.5630	.5052	.5605
FEATURE	Mean	4.049	4.352	3.943
	N	61	61	61
	Std. Deviation	.6508	.8030	.5507
MARGIN	Mean	3.705	4.877	3.672
	N	61	61	61
	Std. Deviation	.5284	.4710	.8923
MARKET DEMAND	Mean	4.508	4.221	3.574
	N	61	61	61
	Std. Deviation	.7851	.6714	.6010
PRICE	Mean	3.738	4.246	4.057
	N	61	61	61
	Std. Deviation	.7875	.5951	.6350
REPUATTION	Mean	4.680	4.164	3.697
	N	61	61	61
	Std. Deviation	.6591	.7466	.6653
SCHEME	Mean	4.164	4.025	3.910
	N	61	61	61
	Std. Deviation	.4628	.5392	.5003
Total	Mean	4.115	4.289	3.817
	N	488	488	488
	Std. Deviation	.9678	.8086	.7213

GEOMETRY BOX:

PARAMETERS		CLASSMATE	DOMS	CAMLIN
DESIGN & LOOKS	Mean	3.988	4.638	4.050
	N	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.5377	.6393	.5355
FUNCTIONALITY	Mean	3.763	4.600	4.250
	N	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.7729	.6932	.6443
MARGIN PROVIDED	Mean	3.556	4.681	4.025
	N	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.7750	.6381	.5929
MARKET DEMAND	Mean	3.763	4.600	4.338
	N	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.6090	.7022	.6719
SELLS PM	Mean	3.813	4.344	4.394
	N	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.6839	.7298	.7102
STOCK LEVEL	Mean	3.756	4.489	3.869
	N	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.6117	.6559	.5841
VALUE FOR MONEY	Mean	4.006	4.613	4.031
	N	160	160	160
	Std. Deviation	.4824	.7180	.5311
Total	Mean	3.806	4.625	4.137
	N	1120	1120	1120
	Std. Deviation	.6610	.6820	.6370

Interpretation:

- As per the descriptive analysis, in the writing instrument segment LINC has the highest total mean value. Hauser has the highest mean in terms of sale per month and stocking while DOMS has the highest mean in providing margin and design and looks.
- In the premium notebooks segment, Classmate has the highest total mean value in terms of Design and looks, Market Demand, Sell PM and Stock level. DOMS has the highest mean in terms of Margin provided and Quality.
- In the Premium pen segment, Parker has the highest total mean value in terms of Company Benefit, Market demand, Reputation and Scheme. Pierre Cardin has the highest mean in terms of Availability, Feature, Margin and Price.
- In the Geometry box segment, DOMS has the highest total mean value from all the aspects, which shows DOMS is the highest market leader in Geometry box segment.

3. Impact of Demographic variable on Depended and Independent Variable

Demographic Variables play a significant role in influencing consumer behavior and, consequently, the brand awareness and sales of PAPERKRAFT pens.

Impact on Product-Related Factors

- Age: Younger demographics may be more receptive to innovative designs and features, while older consumers might prioritize traditional designs and durability.
- Occupation: Professionals and students may have different preferences for pen features and price points based on their specific needs and budgets.

- **Income Level:** Higher-income consumers may be more willing to pay a premium for premium-quality pens with advanced features, while lower-income consumers might prioritize affordability.

Impact on Market-Related Factors

- **Education Level:** Higher-educated consumers may be more aware of brands and product features, influencing their purchasing decisions.
- **Location:** Geographic location can impact the availability and popularity of certain brands. For example, in Siliguri, where PAPERKRAFT pen availability is high, brand awareness and sales are likely to be higher.

Impact on Retailer-Centric Factors

- **Income Level:** Retailers in areas with higher income levels may be more likely to stock premium-quality pens like PAPERKRAFT.
- **Consumer Demand:** Retailers in areas with a higher demand for branded pens may be more inclined to offer incentives or promotions for PAPERKRAFT pens.

4. Reliability

Reliability in research refers to the consistency and stability of a measurement. A reliable measure produces similar results when applied repeatedly under the same conditions. It's essential for ensuring that research findings are accurate and trustworthy.

5. Composite reliability

Composite reliability is a specific measure of internal consistency used in structural equation modelling (SEM). It assesses the extent to which a set of items measures a single underlying construct.

6. Cronbach alpha

Cronbach's alpha is a statistical measure of internal consistency reliability. It evaluates how closely related a set of items are as a group. A higher Cronbach's alpha indicates better internal consistency.

7. Validity

Item-Total Statistics				
	Scale Mean if Item Deleted	Scale Variance if Item Deleted	Corrected Item-Total Correlation	Cronbach's Alpha if Item Deleted
BRANDREPUTATION	13.294	25.152	.787	.861
Benefitsprovided	13.275	25.974	.743	.877
MARKETDEMAND	13.213	26.521	.742	.877
SCHEMES	13.113	24.453	.812	.851

Reliability Statistics	
Cronbach's Alpha	N of Items
.897	4

Item-Total Statistics				
	Scale Mean if Item Deleted	Scale Variance if Item Deleted	Corrected Item-Total Correlation	Cronbach's Alpha if Item Deleted
PRODUCT FEATURES	8.031	10.056	.747	.715
SEASONALITY	7.638	10.736	.610	.851
MARGIN	7.906	10.274	.728	.734

Reliability Statistics	
Cronbach's Alpha	N of Items
.833	3

Reliability is the measure of internal consistency of the constructs in the study, A construct is reliable if the Alpha (α) value is greater than 0.70 (Hair et al, 2013). Construct reliability was assessed using Cronbach's Alpha. The results revealed that the Market-Driven scale with four items and the Product-centric scale with three items ($\alpha = .920$) were found reliable. Reliability results are summarized in the table:

CONSTRUCTS	NO. OF ITEMS	ALPHA
Market-Driven Scale	4	0.897
Product-Centric Scale	3	0.833

8. Statistical Analysis interpretation

HYPOTHESIS TESTING:

HYPOTHESIS 1

Chi-Square Tests			
	Value	df	Asymp. Sig. (2-sided)
Pearson Chi-Square	1.711 ^a	2	.425

Interpretation:

Since the calculated chi-square value (0.425) is less than the critical value (which would be greater than 0, assuming a standard chi-square test), we fail to reject the null hypothesis. This

means there is insufficient evidence to suggest a relationship between occupation and brand awareness for PAPERKRAFT pens.

HYPOTHESIS 2

Chi-Square Tests			
	Value	df	Asymp. Sig. (2-sided)
Pearson Chi-Square	3.490 ^a	8	.900

Interpretation:

With a calculated chi-square value of 0.900, which is likely less than the critical value, we fail to reject the null hypothesis. There is no significant evidence to suggest that the purpose of buying a premium pen affects the brand selected.

HYPOTHESIS 3

Chi-Square Tests			
	Value	df	Asymp. Sig. (2-sided)
Pearson Chi-Square	29.574 ^a	8	0.00025135

Interpretation:

The calculated chi-square value of 0.000251 is significantly smaller than any reasonable critical value. Therefore, we reject the null hypothesis. There is strong evidence suggesting a relationship between the choice of premium pen and the consumer's budget range.

HYPOTHESIS 4

Chi-Square Tests			
	Value	df	Asymp. Sig. (2-sided)
Pearson Chi-Square	13.572 ^a	2	.00113

Interpretation:

With a calculated chi-square value of 0.00113, which is significantly smaller than any reasonable critical value, we reject the null hypothesis. There is strong evidence indicating a relationship between store size and the availability of PAPERKRAFT pens.

FACTOR ANALYSIS:

Factor analysis identified two primary segments of retailers:

a. Market-Driven Retailers

This segment of retailers is primarily influenced by factors such as:

- Brand reputation: The strength and image of the PAPERKRAFT brand.
- Schemes: Promotional offers, discounts, and incentives provided by the company.
- Market demand: The overall demand for premium pens in the market.
- Benefits provided: Additional perks or value-added services offered with the product.

b. Product-Driven Retailers

This group of retailers is more focused on product-centric factors:

- Product features: The specific attributes and functionalities of the pen.
- Seasonality: The impact of seasonal variations on product demand.
- Margin provided: The profit margin offered by PAPERKRAFT.

It's important to note that while availability and price were included in the factor analysis, they emerged as less influential factors in the retailer decision-making process.

KMO and Bartlett's Test Results:

To assess the suitability of the data for factor analysis, two key tests were conducted:

- **KMO Test:** This test measures the proportion of variance in the variables that is common variance. A value greater than 0.5 is generally considered acceptable. In your case, the KMO value of 0.844 indicates that the data is highly suitable for factor analysis.
- **Bartlett's Test of Sphericity:** This test assesses whether the variables in the correlation matrix are significantly different from each other. A significant result ($p\text{-value} < 0.05$) indicates that factor analysis is appropriate. Your Bartlett's test yielded a $p\text{-value}$ of 0.000213, which is less than 0.05, confirming the suitability of factor analysis.

KMO and Bartlett's Test		
Kaiser-Meyer-Olkin Measure of Sampling Adequacy.		0.844
Bartlett's Test of Sphericity	Approx. Chi-Square	705.132
	df	36
	Sig.	0.0000213
Based on correlations		

Rotated Component Matrix ^a		
	Component	
	MARKET-DRIVEN RETAILER	PRODUCT-CENTRIC RETAILER
BRAND REPUTATION	.868	-.156
PRODUCT FEATURE	-.331	.815
BENEFITS PROVIDED	.842	-.126
PRICE	.070	.390
SEASONALITY	-.007	.824
AVAILABILITY	-.353	.650
MARKETDEMAND	.845	-.108
SCHEMES	.893	-.102
MARGIN	-.263	.804

ATTRIBUTE BASED PERCEPTUAL MAPPING (ABPM):

The Attribute-Based Perceptual Mapping (ABPM) analysis positioned PAPERKRAFT, Parker, and Pierre Cardin in relation to two identified components, Z1 and Z2.

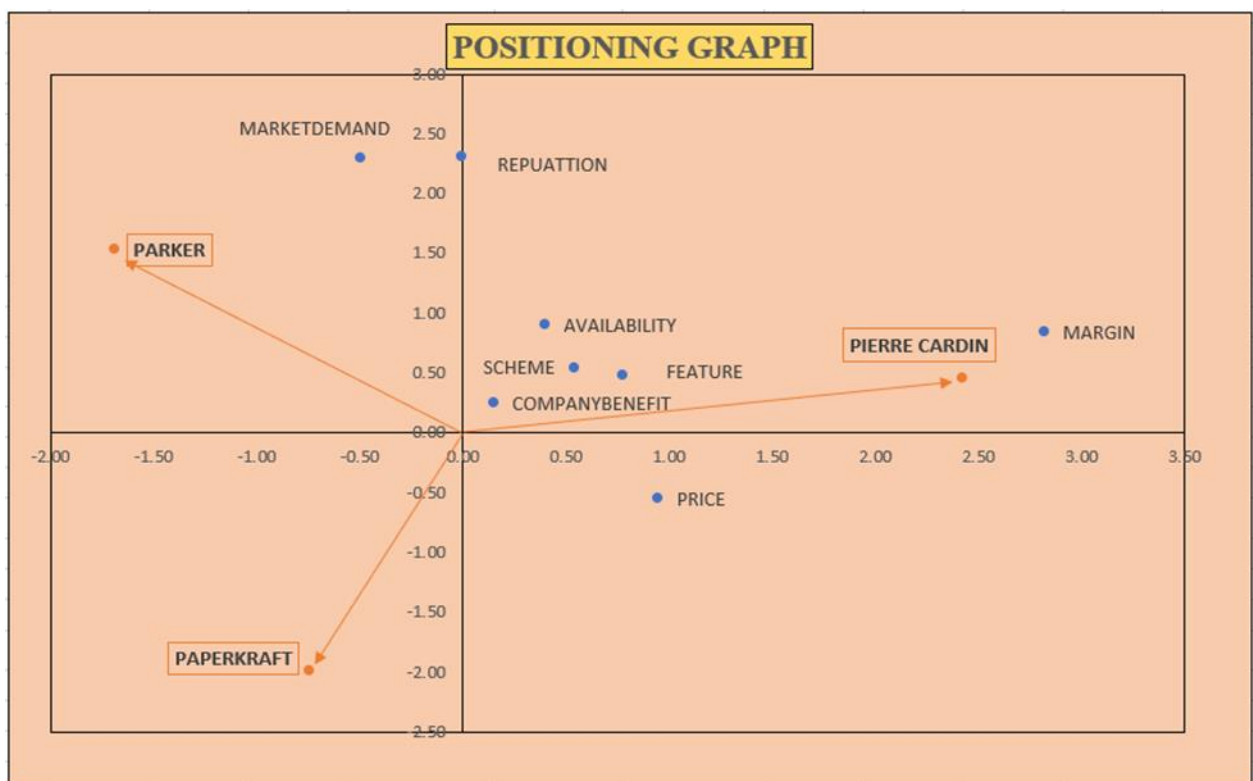
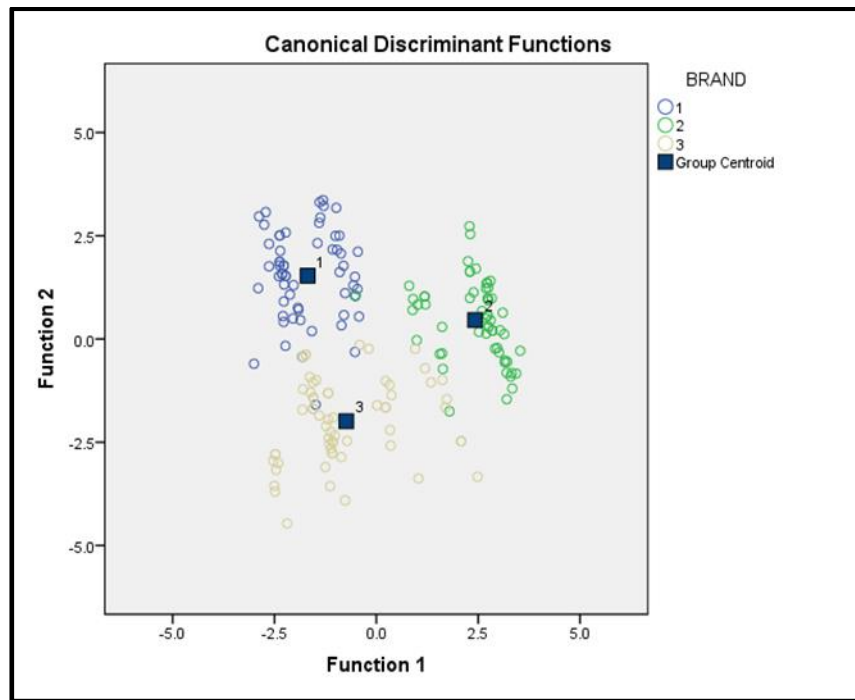
- Component Z1: This component had an eigenvalue of 3.137 and a Wilks' lambda of 0.075.
- Component Z2: This component had an eigenvalue of 2.209 and a Wilks' lambda of 0.312.

The eigenvalues greater than 1 and Wilks' lambda values less than 0.5 indicate that both components are significant and contribute to explaining the variance in the data.

The classification result of **94.5%** suggests that the model accurately classifies the data points, indicating a good fit.

	>1	<.5
	EIGENVALUE	WILKS' LAMBDA
Z1	3.137	.075
Z2	2.209	.312

Classification Results ^a						
BRAND			Predicted Group Membership			Total
			1.0	2.0	3.0	
Original	Count	1.0	58	0	3	61
		2.0	1	60	0	61
		3.0	0	6	55	61
	%	1.0	95.1	0.0	4.9	100.0
		2.0	1.6	98.4	0.0	100.0
		3.0	0.0	9.8	90.2	100.0
a. 94.5% of original grouped cases correctly classified.						



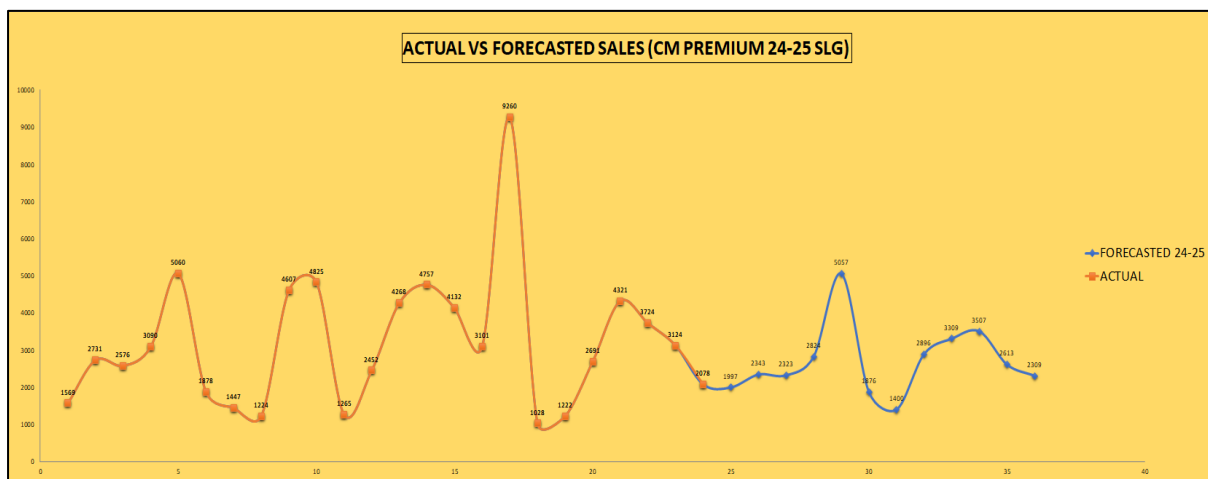
1. FORECASTING

To accurately predict sales for the upcoming financial year (2024-25), a comprehensive forecasting model was developed. Given the unprecedented impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on sales during the 2020-2021 financial year, this period was excluded from the analysis to mitigate its distorting influence on the data.

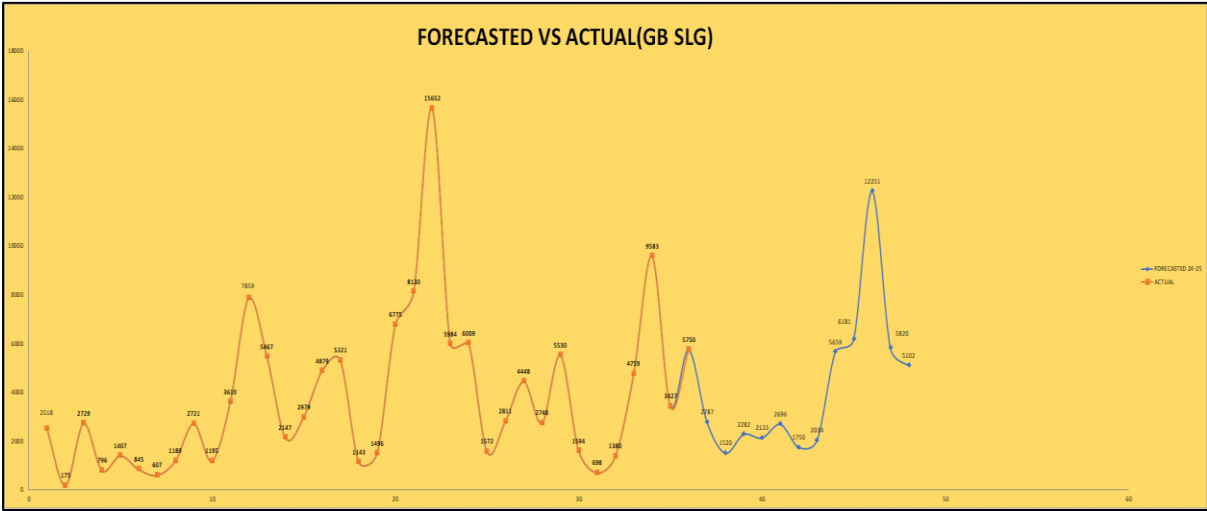
The forecasting process commenced with a detailed examination of historical sales data spanning from FY 2013-14 to FY 2023-24. To account for seasonal fluctuations inherent in sales patterns, a seasonality adjustment was applied to the monthly data. Subsequently, the presence of underlying trends within the adjusted data was investigated.

By incorporating both seasonal factors and identified trends, a predictive model was constructed to forecast sales for the financial year 2024-25. It is important to note that while the model endeavors to account for historical patterns, unforeseen external factors could potentially impact the accuracy of the forecast.

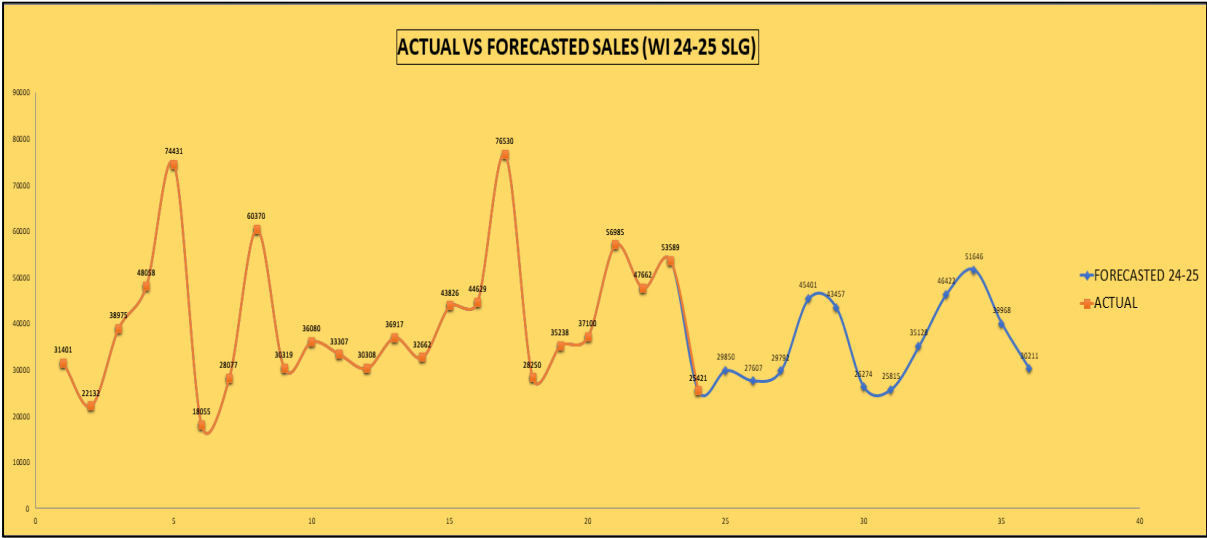
CLASSMATE PREMIUM NOTEBOOKS



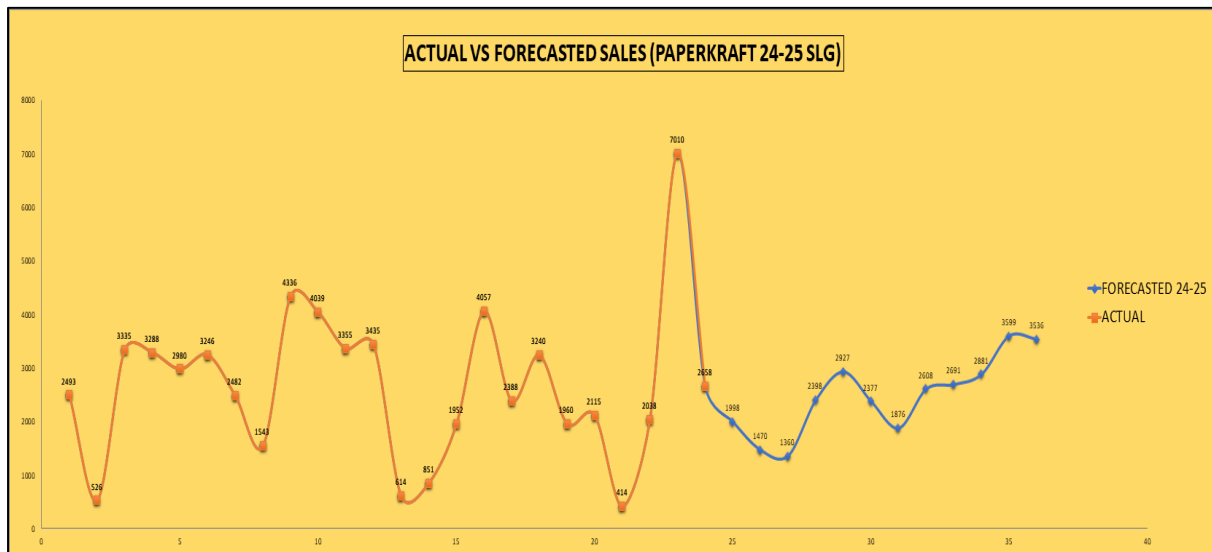
GEOMETRY BOX



WRITING INSTRUMENTS:



PAPERKRAFT:



Chapter 5: Conclusion and recommendations

1. Findings and Analysis

- i. The research findings indicate that consumer occupation and the specific purpose of purchasing a premium pen do not significantly influence brand choice. However, a strong correlation exists between the price range of premium pens and consumer selection, suggesting that budget is a primary determinant in this category. Additionally, the availability of PAPERKRAFT pens is influenced by the size of the retail outlet, with larger stores demonstrating a higher likelihood of carrying the product.
- ii. In the Siliguri market, Linc, DOMS, and Hauser dominate the economy pen segment (priced around INR 10), enjoying strong consumer pull. Octane, on the other hand,

struggles with lower market demand and a perceived mediocrity in design and writing experience.

- iii. Classmate Pulse emerges as the market leader in premium notebooks, despite offering lower margins compared to competitors. This suggests a strong brand preference and consumer demand for the product. DOMS, while offering higher margins, has not achieved the same level of market dominance.
- iv. DOMS outperforms both Classmate and Camlin in the geometry box category, demonstrating superior product features, higher market demand, and better profit margins.
- v. Parker holds the leading position in the premium pen segment, driven by strong consumer demand. However, the brand operates on relatively low profit margins. Pierre Cardin is a notable competitor, offering higher profit margins and intensifying competition with Parker.
- vi. PAPERKRAFT faces challenges in terms of brand awareness, profit margins, and stock availability. These factors collectively hinder the brand's competitive position in the market.

2. Suggestions

Based on the research findings, the following recommendations are proposed to enhance PAPERKRAFT's market position and drive sales growth:

i. Building Brand Awareness

- Comprehensive Brand Building Campaign: Develop a robust brand building campaign targeting both retailers and consumers. This should include a clear brand identity, messaging, and visual elements.
- Retailer Education: Conduct extensive training programs for retailers to increase their knowledge about PAPERKRAFT, its features, and benefits. This will help in generating enthusiasm and support among retailers.
- Consumer Promotions: Implement consumer-centric promotions and offers to create awareness and drive demand for PAPERKRAFT pens.

ii. Enhancing Product Appeal

- **Product Redesign:** Re-evaluate the design of the 10 rupee pen to improve its ergonomics and aesthetics. Consider conducting consumer research to gather insights into preferred pen designs.
- **Product Line Expansion:** Introduce a new pen segment in the 20-30 rupee range to cater to a wider audience and increase market penetration.
- **Product Differentiation:** Develop unique product features or benefits to distinguish PAPERKRAFT from competitors. This could involve incorporating innovative technologies, eco-friendly materials, or specialized pen tips.

iii. Improving Retailer Relationships

- **Attractive Incentives:** Offer competitive margins and incentives to encourage retailers to stock and promote PAPERKRAFT pens. Consider implementing a tiered incentive program based on sales performance.
- **Exclusive Offerings:** Develop exclusive product lines or limited-edition pens for key retailers to create a sense of exclusivity and drive sales.
- **Stronger Sales Support:** Provide dedicated sales support to retailers, including training, merchandising assistance, and regular visits.

iv. Leveraging Research Insights

- **Target Market Segmentation:** Utilize the segmentation of retailers into market-driven and product-driven groups to tailor marketing and sales efforts accordingly.
- **ABPM Action Plan:** Develop a strategic plan based on the insights from the ABPM analysis to reposition PAPERKRAFT and create a stronger brand image.
- **Continuous Monitoring:** Implement a system to track brand perception, retailer sentiment, and sales performance over time to measure the effectiveness of the implemented strategies and make necessary adjustments.

v. SIFI App Enhancement:

Integrate high-quality product images and detailed specifications into the SIFI app to enable sales representatives to effectively showcase the product range to retailers. This will enhance product demonstrations and facilitate informed decision-making.

vi. Target-Based Incentives:

Implement a quarterly, half-yearly, or yearly target system for retailers, with incentives such as gift vouchers or additional margins for achieving sales goals. This will motivate retailers to prioritize PAPERKRAFT and drive sales growth.

3. Conclusion

The research on the competitive landscape of ITC's PENS and PREMIUM portfolio, with a specific focus on PAPERKRAFT pens, has unveiled critical challenges hindering the brand's growth. Low brand awareness, weak retailer relationships, and suboptimal product positioning have collectively contributed to PAPERKRAFT's under-performance. Factor analysis revealed distinct retailer segments: market-driven and product-driven. Understanding these segments is crucial for tailoring marketing and sales efforts. The ABPM analysis highlighted PAPERKRAFT's position relative to competitors, indicating opportunities for brand elevation and product differentiation.

To address these challenges and enhance PAPERKRAFT's market position, a multi-faceted approach is necessary. Building a strong brand identity, improving product appeal, fostering robust retailer relationships, and leveraging data-driven insights are key to driving sales growth.

Specific recommendations include comprehensive brand building campaigns, product redesigns, attractive retailer incentives, sales force empowerment through the SIFI app, and a focus on target-based performance metrics. By implementing these strategies and continuously

monitoring market dynamics, ITC can effectively address the value gap, strengthen PAPERKRAFT's position, and achieve sustainable growth in the competitive pen market.

4. Managerial Implication

Based on the research findings, ITC can implement the following strategies to enhance PAPERKRAFT's market position and drive sales growth:

- **Strengthen Brand Awareness:** Develop a comprehensive brand building campaign, educate retailers, and implement consumer promotions to increase brand visibility and recognition.
- **Improve Product Appeal:** Redesign the 10 rupee pen to enhance its ergonomics and aesthetics, expand the product line to cater to a wider audience, and differentiate PAPERKRAFT through unique features and benefits.
- **Foster Retailer Relationships:** Offer attractive incentives, provide exclusive offerings, and strengthen sales support to encourage retailers to stock and promote PAPERKRAFT pens.
- **Leverage Research Insights:** Utilize the segmentation of retailers into market-driven and product-driven groups to tailor marketing and sales efforts accordingly. Develop a strategic action plan based on the ABPM analysis to reposition PAPERKRAFT and create a stronger brand image.
- **Enhance SIFI App:** Integrate high-quality product images and detailed specifications into the SIFI app to improve sales effectiveness.
- **Implement Target-Based Incentives:** Motivate retailers with performance-based incentives to prioritize PAPERKRAFT and drive sales growth.

5. Future scope of work (if any)

Based on the findings and recommendations presented in the report, several areas for future research and collaboration can be explored to further enhance understanding and drive growth for PAPERKRAFT:

Regional Analysis:

- **Regional Variations:** Explore regional variations in consumer preferences, market dynamics, and competitive landscapes to tailor marketing and sales efforts accordingly.
- **Geographic Expansion:** Assess the potential for expanding PAPERKRAFT's presence in different regions of India or even international markets.

Customer Segmentation:

- **Refine Segmentation:** Refine the existing segmentation of retailers into market-driven and product-driven groups based on additional factors (e.g., store size, customer demographics).
- **Tailored Strategies:** Develop more targeted marketing and sales strategies for each segment.

Product Innovation:

- **Explore New Features:** Research and develop innovative features that align with consumer preferences and market trends.
- **Collaborate with Designers:** Collaborate with designers to create visually appealing and functional pen designs.

Digital Marketing:

- **Social Media Engagement:** Increase engagement on social media platforms to build brand awareness and connect with consumers.
- **Influencer Marketing:** Collaborate with influencers in the stationery or lifestyle niche to reach a wider audience.

Global Expansion:

- **Market Research:** Conduct market research in potential international markets to assess demand and identify suitable partners.
- **Regulatory Compliance:** Understand and comply with international regulations and standards.

Chapter 6: Practical Learning & Contribution

1. Internship Summary

The internship at ITC's ESPB division offered a comprehensive immersion into the dynamic landscape of sales and marketing within the fast-moving consumer goods (FMCG) industry. Focused on the Siliguri market, the role encompassed a strategic blend of market development, sales execution, customer relationship management, and data-driven decision making. Key responsibilities included expanding the distributor network, driving sales growth, optimizing distribution efficiency, conducting market research, and implementing effective sales strategies. Through hands-on experience and exposure to various functional areas, the intern gained a robust understanding of the industry dynamics, consumer behavior, the intricacies of distribution channel management, and the importance of data-driven insights in driving business growth.

The internship provided a platform to develop essential skills such as market analysis, sales forecasting, negotiation, and problem-solving. The opportunity to collaborate with cross-functional teams and build strong relationships with distributors and retailers further enhanced the overall learning experience.

2. Internship Designation & Duration

The internship was a two-month intensive program spanning from June 10th to August 10th, providing a concentrated exposure to the industry.

3. Internship – Roles & Responsibilities

The internship encompassed a diverse range of responsibilities, including:

- **Market Expansion:** Actively sought and on boarded new distributors to expand market reach and increase sales potential.
- **Sales Execution:** Collaborated closely with distributors to achieve sales targets and drive market penetration.

- **Market Research:** Conducted thorough market research to gather valuable insights into customer preferences and competitor activities.
- **Operational Support:** Provided support to distributors in various operational aspects, such as order processing, inventory management, and collections.
- **Data Management:** Maintained accurate and up-to-date sales and market data for analysis and reporting purposes.
- **Training and Development:** Conducted training sessions for distributors on product knowledge, sales techniques, and the use of sales tools.

4. Task Performed:

My internship at ITC's ESPB division involved a comprehensive immersion into the sales and distribution operations within the Siliguri market. Key responsibilities included:

1. **Market Research and Analysis:** Conducting in-depth market research to understand consumer preferences, competitor dynamics, and distribution channel effectiveness.
2. **Sales and Distribution:** Actively participating in sales activities, including order taking, billing, and inventory management. Collaborated with distributors to expand market reach and optimize sales performance.
3. **Scheme communication:** Communicated exclusive schemes throughout the retail outlets. Elaborate the scheme features and benefits of the scheme to retailers.
4. **Data Management and Analysis:** Utilizing the SIFI app and FORUM NXT ERP. Generated sales forecasts and identified areas for improvement.
5. **Relationship Building:** Developing strong relationships with retailers, distributors, and internal stakeholders to foster effective collaboration.
6. **Market Expansion:** Contributed to the expansion of the distribution network by adding new stockists and retail outlets.
7. **Training and Development:** Provided training to sales personnel on the use of the SIFI app for improved efficiency.

5. Expected Competency (Knowledge & Skill & Attitude)

To excel in this role, a robust skill set was essential. These core competencies included:

Product Mastery: A deep understanding of ESPB products, their unique selling points, and their alignment with customer needs.

Market Acumen: The ability to analyze market trends, identify growth opportunities, and tailor strategies accordingly.

Persuasive Communication: Effective communication and negotiation skills to build strong relationships with distributors, retailers, and internal stakeholders.

Data-Driven Decision Making: Proficiency in data analysis and interpretation to extract valuable insights for informed decision-making.

Problem Solving: The ability to identify challenges, analyse root causes, and implement effective solutions.

Relationship Building: Strong interpersonal skills to foster trust and collaboration with stakeholders at all levels.

Time Management: Efficient prioritization and execution of tasks to meet deadlines and achieve objectives.

6. Achieved Competency with justification (Knowledge & Skill & Attitude)

ATTITUDE

Resilience and Problem-Solving: Demonstrated the ability to handle challenges and complaints effectively during retail visits, showcasing a problem-solving mindset and a commitment to finding solutions.

Adaptability: Successfully adjusted to the dynamic market environment and changing customer needs, displaying flexibility and open-mindedness.

Proactive Approach: Took initiative to identify and address issues proactively, showcasing a sense of ownership and responsibility.

SKILLS

Product Knowledge: Acquired a comprehensive understanding of ESPB products, including features, benefits, and target market segments.

Sales and Negotiation: Developed effective sales and negotiation skills through successful interactions with distributors and retailers.

Market Analysis: Demonstrated the ability to analyze market trends, competitor activities, and identify growth opportunities.

Data Analysis: Utilized data to inform decision-making, track performance, and identify areas for improvement.

Relationship Building: Established strong relationships with distributors and retailers, fostering trust and collaboration.

Time Management and Organization: Effectively managed multiple tasks and priorities within tight deadlines.

Communication and Interpersonal Skills: Effectively communicated with stakeholders at all levels, building rapport and influencing others.

KNOWLEDGE

Market Dynamics: Developed a deep understanding of the Siliguri market, including customer preferences, distribution channels, and competitive landscape.

Sales and Distribution Processes: Acquired knowledge of the sales and distribution processes, including order processing, inventory management, and logistics.

Financial Analysis: Gained proficiency in calculating margins, ROI, and conducting basic financial analysis.

Documentation and Compliance: Developed knowledge of the documentation required for onboarding new distributors and stockists, ensuring compliance with regulations.

Market Research: Acquired skills in conducting market research to gather insights into consumer behavior and preferences.

7. Overall Learning outcomes

The internship offered a transformative learning experience, providing a solid foundation for a career in sales and marketing. Key learning outcomes include:

- Industry Immersion: A deep understanding of the FMCG industry, with a focus on the education and stationery segment.
- Sales and Marketing Fundamentals: Practical application of sales and marketing concepts in a real-world business environment.
- Distribution Channel Management: Insights into the complexities of managing a distribution network and building strong distributor relationships.
- Problem-Solving and Decision Making: Development of critical thinking and problem-solving skills to address challenges effectively.
- Professional Development: Enhancement of interpersonal, communication, and presentation skills for effective stakeholder management.

8. Overall contribution to the company in the Internship duration

The internship at ITC's ESPB division provided an opportunity to contribute significantly to the company's sales and distribution objectives in the Siliguri market.

1. Market Expansion: A strategic focus on expanding the distribution network led to the successful onboarding of one new stockiest and one distributor, broadening the product reach in the region. Additionally, the identification and development of 17 new retail outlets, including a dedicated sales route in Matigara, resulted in increased market penetration.

2. Sales Performance: Demonstrated strong sales acumen by achieving individual sales targets and contributing to overall team objectives. Specifically, generated INR 21,700 in sales during the initial two weeks and INR 12,000 in the subsequent two weeks.
3. Product Focus: Successfully increased PAPERKRAFT pen penetration by 3%, elevating its presence from 14% to 17% within the market. This achievement was realized through the expansion of product availability from 45 to 59 retail outlets out of a total of 337.
4. Process Improvement and Training: Contributed to operational efficiency by resolving technical issues within the SIFI app and imparting training to sales personnel on store surveys and billing procedures.
5. Data Analysis and Forecasting: Utilized sales data to conduct a preliminary analysis, providing insights for future business strategies. Successfully completed a sales forecast for the upcoming financial year.

9. Questionnaire (if any)

QUESTIONNAIRE FOR RETAILERS

- 1. SHOP NAME**
- 2. LOCATION**
- 3. DISTANCE FROM ANY EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTE**
 - ☐ <1 km
 - ☐ 1-2 km
 - ☐ 3-5 km
- 4. CHANNEL OF PURCHASE THE PRODUCT?**
 - ☐ Distributor
 - ☐ Whole seller/Stockiest
- 5. AVERAGE BILL SIZE PER MONTH?**
 - ☐ <3000

- ☐ 3000-6000
- ☐ 6000-9000
- ☐ 9000-12000
- ☐ 12000-15000
- ☐ 15000-20000
- ☐ >20000

6. STORE SIZE IN SQ. FT.

- ☐ <100
- ☐ 100-250
- ☐ 250-500
- ☐ >500

7. DO YOU HAVE EXTRA STORAGE SPACE APART FROM THE SHOP?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

8. PAPERKRAFT PEN AVAILBILITY?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

9. PURCHASE FREQUENCY OF "PAPERKRAFT" PENS

- ☐ Weekly
- ☐ Fortnightly
- ☐ Monthly
- ☐ Once is Three months
- ☐ Once in Six months
- ☐ NIL

10. PURCHASE QUANTITY OF "PAPERKRAFT" PENS

- ☐ <10
- ☐ 10-20
- ☐ 20-30
- ☐ 30-50
- ☐ 50-100
- ☐ 100-200
- ☐ >200
- ☐ NIL

11. THE BRAND REPUTATION IS ESSENTIAL FOR PURCHASING PREMIUM QUALITY PENS.

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ moderately disagree
- ☐ disagree
- ☐ neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ agree
- ☐ moderately agree
- ☐ strongly agree

12. EXISTING DEMAND OF PRODUCT IN THE MARKET IS AN IMPORTANT FACTOR TO PURCHASE.

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ moderately disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ moderately agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

13. MARGIN PROVIDED BY THE BRAND IS AN IMPORTANT FACTOR TO PURCHASE PREMIUM QUALITY PENS.

- ☐ strongly disagree
- ☐ moderately disagree
- ☐ disagree
- ☐ neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ agree
- ☐ moderately agree
- ☐ strongly agree

14. SCHEMES PROVIDED BY THE BRAND IS AN IMPORTANT FACTOR TO PURCHASE PREMIUM QUALITY PENS.

- ☐ strongly disagree
- ☐ moderately disagree
- ☐ disagree
- ☐ neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ agree
- ☐ moderately agree
- ☐ strongly agree

15. PRODUCT FEATURES(PACKAGING, DESIGN, VARIETY, REFILL AVAILABILITY,) IS AN IMPORTANT FACTOR

- ☐ Question Type
- ☐ strongly disagree
- ☐ moderately disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ moderately agree

- Strongly Agree

16. PRICE OF THE PRODUCT IS AN IMPORTANT FACTOR

- strongly disagree
- moderately disagree
- disagree
- neither agree nor disagree
- agree
- moderately agree
- strongly agree

17. PRODUCT AVAILABILITY IS AN IMPORTANT FACTOR FOR PURCHASE DECISION

- strongly disagree
- moderately disagree
- disagree
- neither agree nor disagree
- agree
- moderately agree
- strongly agree

18. BENEFITS PROVIDED BY THE COMPANY(BUYBACK POLICY, QUICK DELIVERY, CREDIT SYSTEM) IS AN IMPORTANT FACTOR FOR PURCHASE DECISION

- strongly disagree
- moderately disagree
- disagree
- neither agree nor disagree
- agree

- moderately agree
- strongly agree

19. SEASONALITY OF THE PRODUCT IS AN IMPORTANT FACTOR FOR PURCHASING AND STOCKING THE PRODUCT.

- strongly disagree
- moderately disagree
- disagree
- neither agree nor disagree
- agree
- moderately agree
- strongly agree

QUESTIONNAIRE FOR TARGET MARKET CUSTOMERS

1. NAME

2. INSTITUTE OR OFFICE NAME

3. HOME LOCATION

- Urban
- Sub Urban
- Rural

4. AGE

- <18
- 18-23
- 23-30
- 30-45
- >45

5. EDUCATION

- ☐ Secondary
- ☐ Higher Secondary
- ☐ Graduation
- ☐ Masters
- ☐ Ph.D
- ☐ Other

6. OCCUPATION

- ☐ Student
- ☐ Job
- ☐ Business
- ☐ other

7. GENDER

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female
- ☐ Prefer not to say

8. DO YOU KNOW THE BRAND "PAPERKRAFT"?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

9. IF YES, DO YOU KNOW WHICH COMPANY "PAPERKRAFT" BELONGS?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

10. WHAT IS YOUR PURPOSE OF BUYING A PREMIUM QUALITY PEN?

- ☐ Gifting
- ☐ Self use
- ☐ Both

11. FROM WHERE YOU WOULD PREFER TO BUY A PREMIUM QUALITY PEN?

- ☐ Education & Stationary shop
- ☐ Gift shop
- ☐ Other
- ☐ Online

12. WHICH PREMIUM QUALITY PEN YOU WILL BUY IF YOU HAVE A CHOICE?

- ☐ PARKER
- ☐ PAPERKRAFT
- ☐ PIERRE CARDIN
- ☐ CELLO
- ☐ OTHER

13. WHAT WILL BE YOUR BUDGET RANGE?

- ☐ <100
- ☐ 100-200
- ☐ 200-300
- ☐ 300-500
- ☐ 500-1000
- ☐ >1000

14. IN SHOP, IF A SHOPKEEPER RECOMMENDS A NEW BRAND OF PREMIUM QUALITY PEN TO YOU. WOULD YOU BUY IT?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No(I have my preferred brand)
- ☐ Maybe

15. ECO-FRIENDLY MATERIALS USED TO BUILD A PEN AFFECTS YOUR PURCHASE DECISION

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

16. PRICE OF THE PEN AFFECTS YOUR PURCHASE DECISION

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

17. WRITING EXPERIENCE WITH THE PEN AFFECTS YOUR PURCHASE DECISION

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

**18.DESIGN AND LOOKS OF THE PEN AFFECTS YOUR PURCHASE
DECISION**

- Strongly disagree
- Disagree
- Neutral
- Agree
- Strongly agree

**19.BRAND VALUE OF THE PEN AFFECTS YOUR PURCHASE
DECISION**

- Strongly disagree
- Disagree
- Neutral
- Agree
- Strongly agree

**20.PERCEIVED VALUE OF THE PEN AFFECTS YOUR PURCHASE
DECISION**

- Strongly disagree
- Disagree
- Neutral
- Agree
- Strongly agree

**21.AVAILABILITY AND VISIBILITY OF THE PEN IN THE SHOP
AFFECTS YOUR PURCHASE DECISION**

- Strongly disagree
- Disagree

- Neutral
- Agree
- Strongly agree

22. PACKAGING OF THE PEN AFFECTS YOUR PURCHASE DECISION

- Strongly disagree
- Disagree
- Neutral
- Agree
- Strongly agree

23. ADVERTISEMENT/PROMOTION (TV AD, POSTERS, HOARDINGS ETC.) REGARDING THE PEN AFFECTS YOUR PURCHASE DECISION

- Strongly disagree
- Disagree
- Neutral
- Agree
- Strongly agree

10. Reference

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